



NYU

Missing Persons

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Cumulative NamUs Cases

- Scaling of Cumulative Cases vs Population
- Choropleths
- Demographic Analysis of Cases
 - Population Pyramids
 - Sex Distribution
 - Race/Ethnicity Distribution

NamUs Missing Persons Cases Data Characteristics

- We have **25,630** available records and use **16,370** records (from 2000-2024), within the decades:

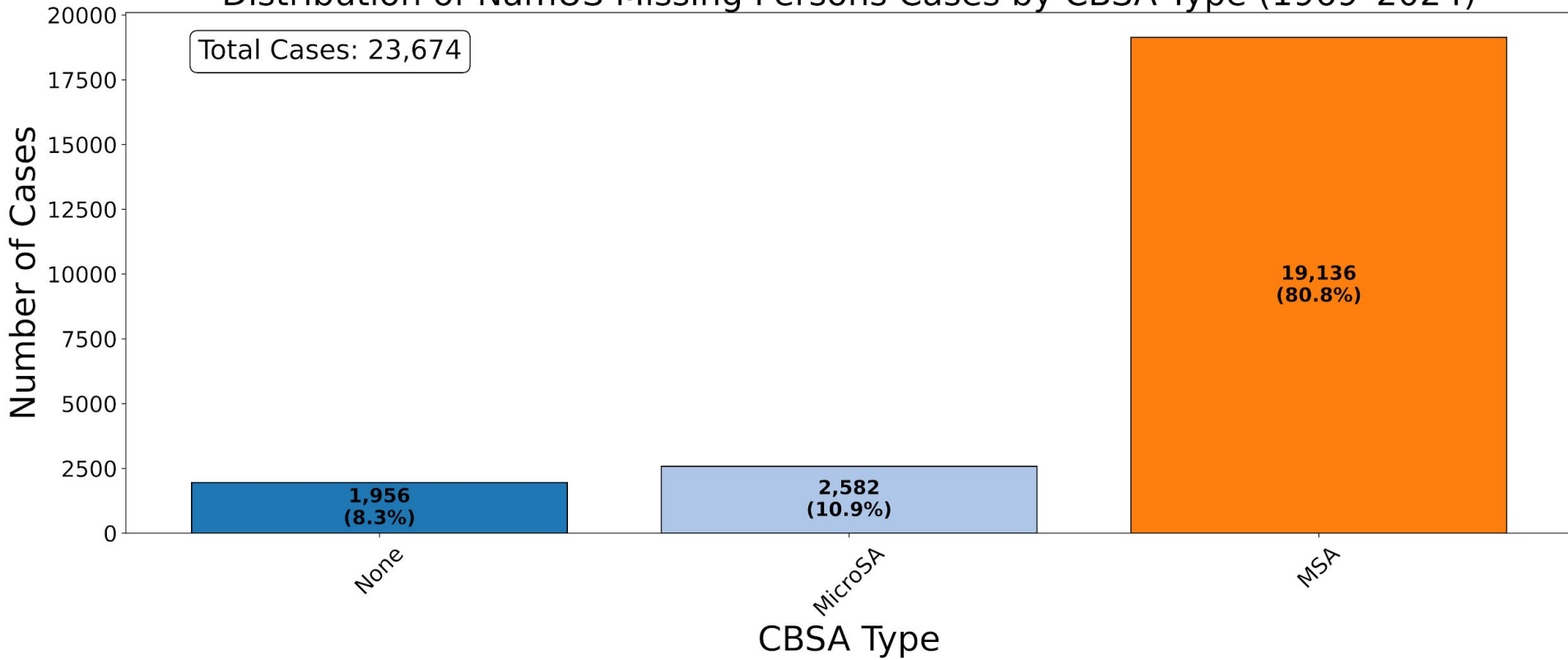
- 1900-1910: **1**
- 1910-1920: **2**
- 1920-1930: **6**
- 1930-1940: **8**
- 1940-1950: **30**
- 1950-1960: **86**
- 1960-1970: **268**
- 1970-1980: **1272**
- 1980-1990: **2961**
- 1990-2000: **3534**
- 2000-2010: **4465**
- 2010-2020: **6396**
- 2020-2024: **5899**
- 2025: **702**

- The data missing per column is as follows:

- CaseID: **0.00%**
- FirstName: **0.00%**
- MiddleName: **24.78%**
- LastName: **0.00%**
- Nicknames: **72.19%**
- CurrentMinAge: **0.00%**
- CurrentMaxAge: **0.00%**
- Sex: **0.00%**
- Ethnicity: **0.00%**
- HeightInches: **0.14%**
- WeightPounds: **0.19%**
- EyeColor: **2.41%**
- HairColor: **1.76%**
- DisappearanceDate: **0.00%**
- City: **0.42%**
- State: **0.00%**
- County: **0.31%**
- InvestigatingAgency: **0.01%**

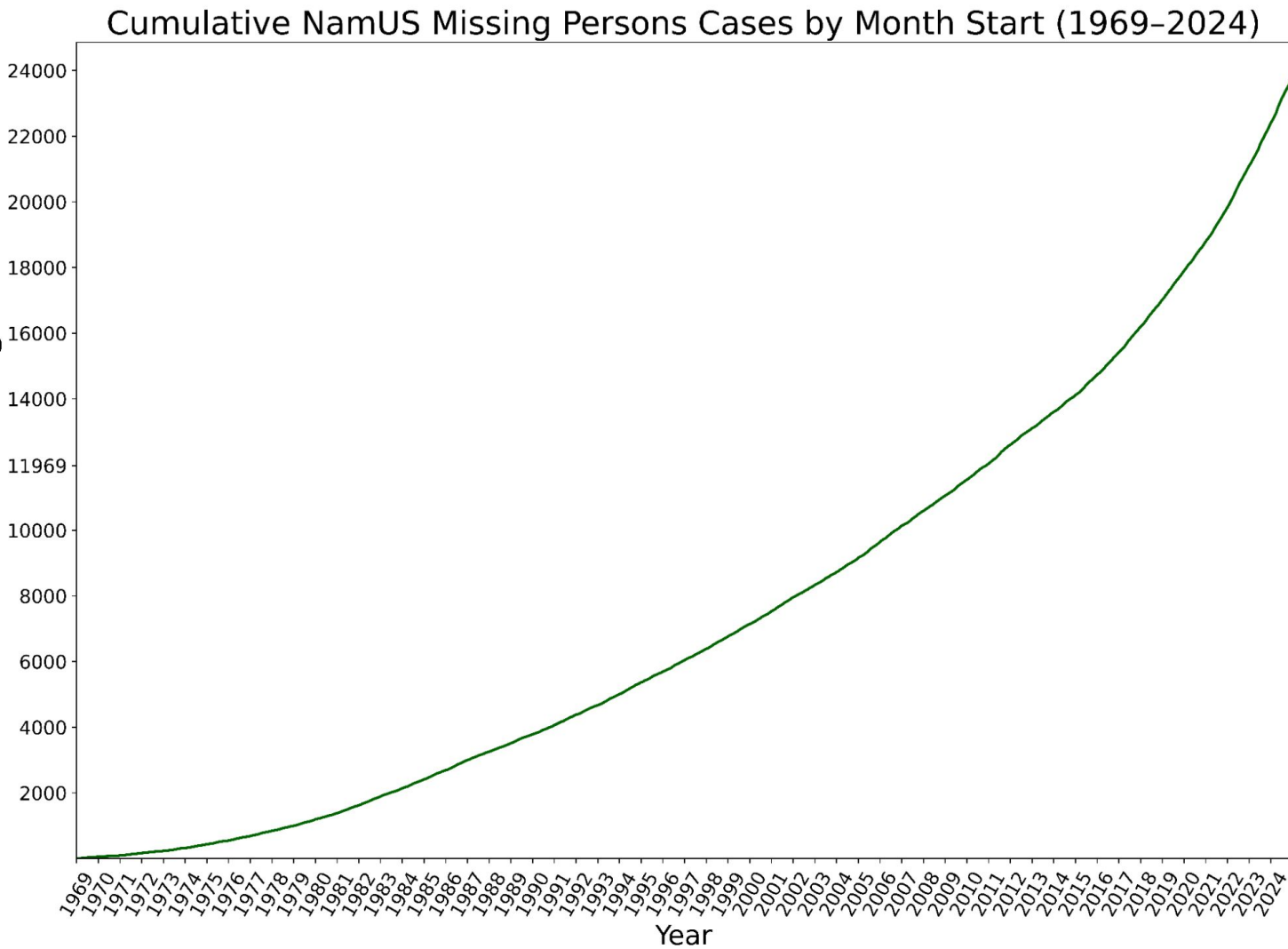
NamUs Cases [1969-2024]

Distribution of NamUS Missing Persons Cases by CBSA Type (1969-2024)

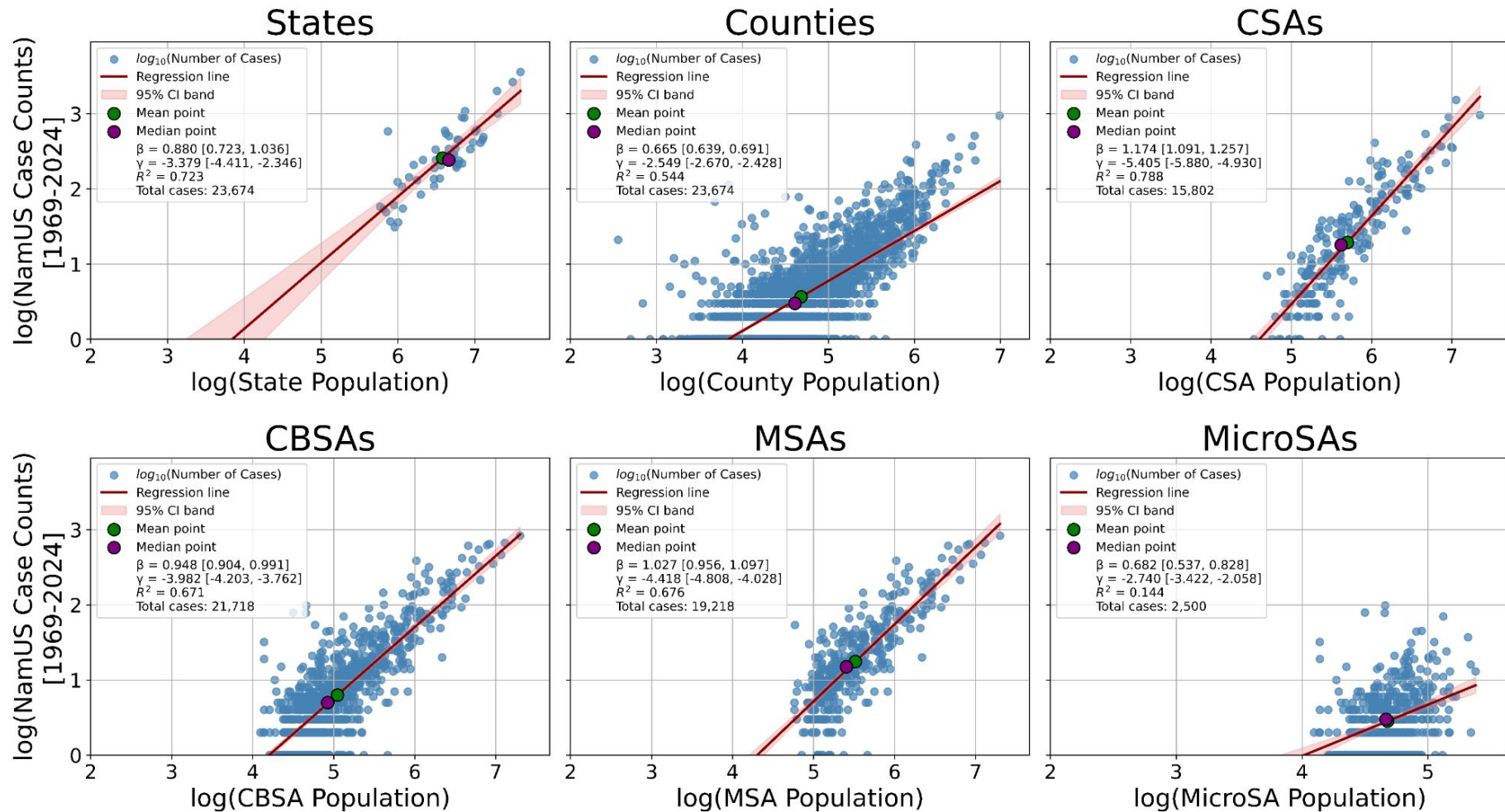




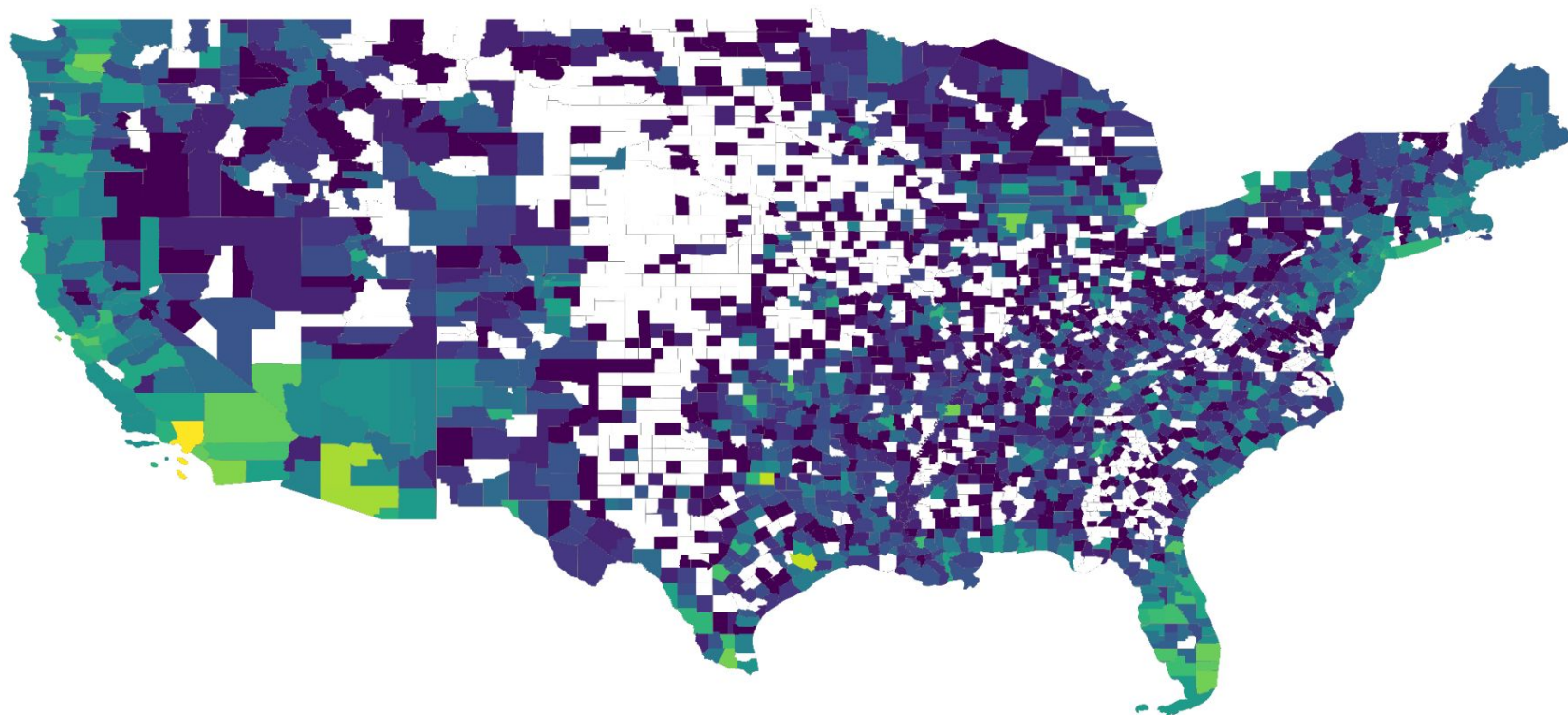
Cumulative NamUS Missing Persons Cases



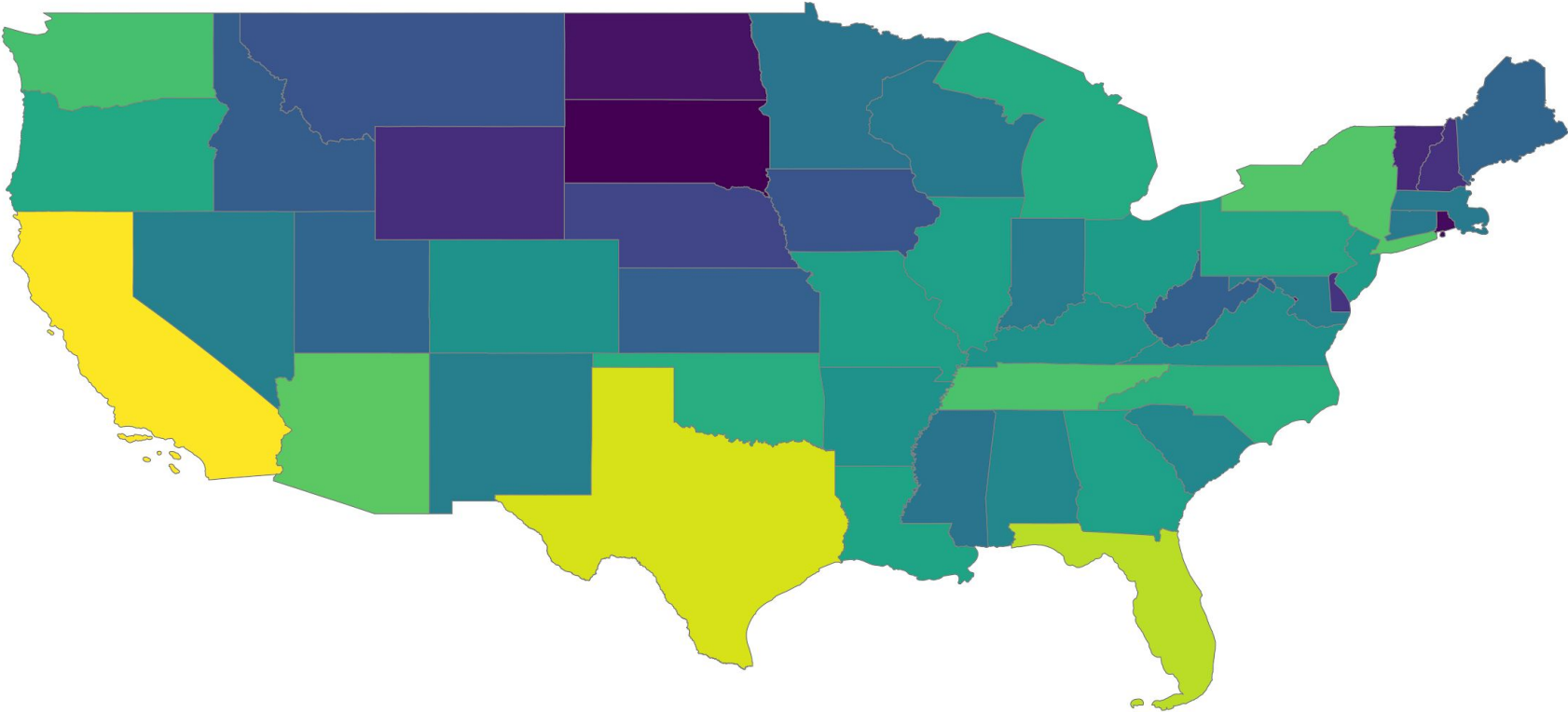
Scaling Exponent (β) of NamUS Missing Persons Cases vs GEOID Population [1969–2024]



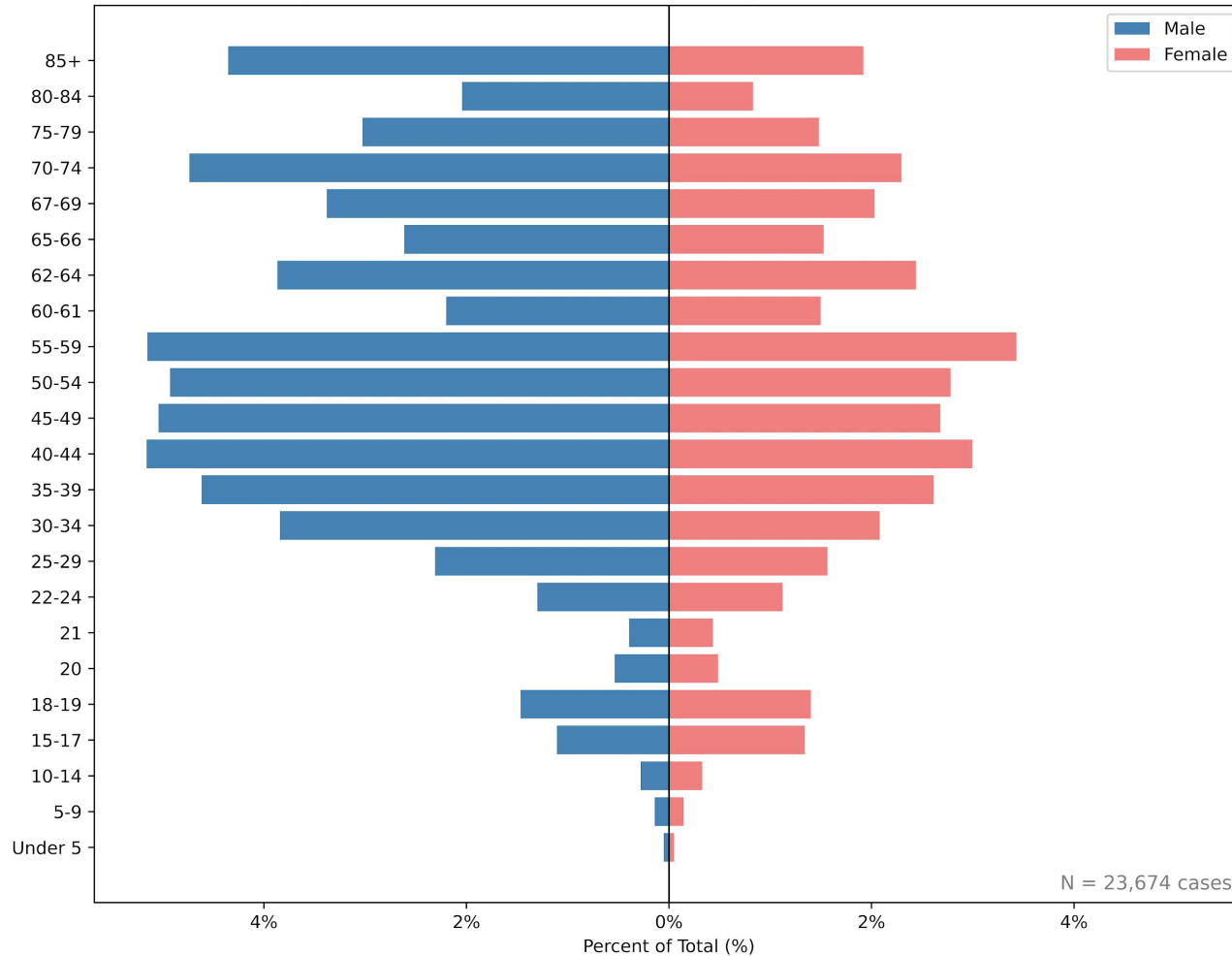
Cumulative NamUs Missing Person Cases by County (Continental U.S., 1969-2024)



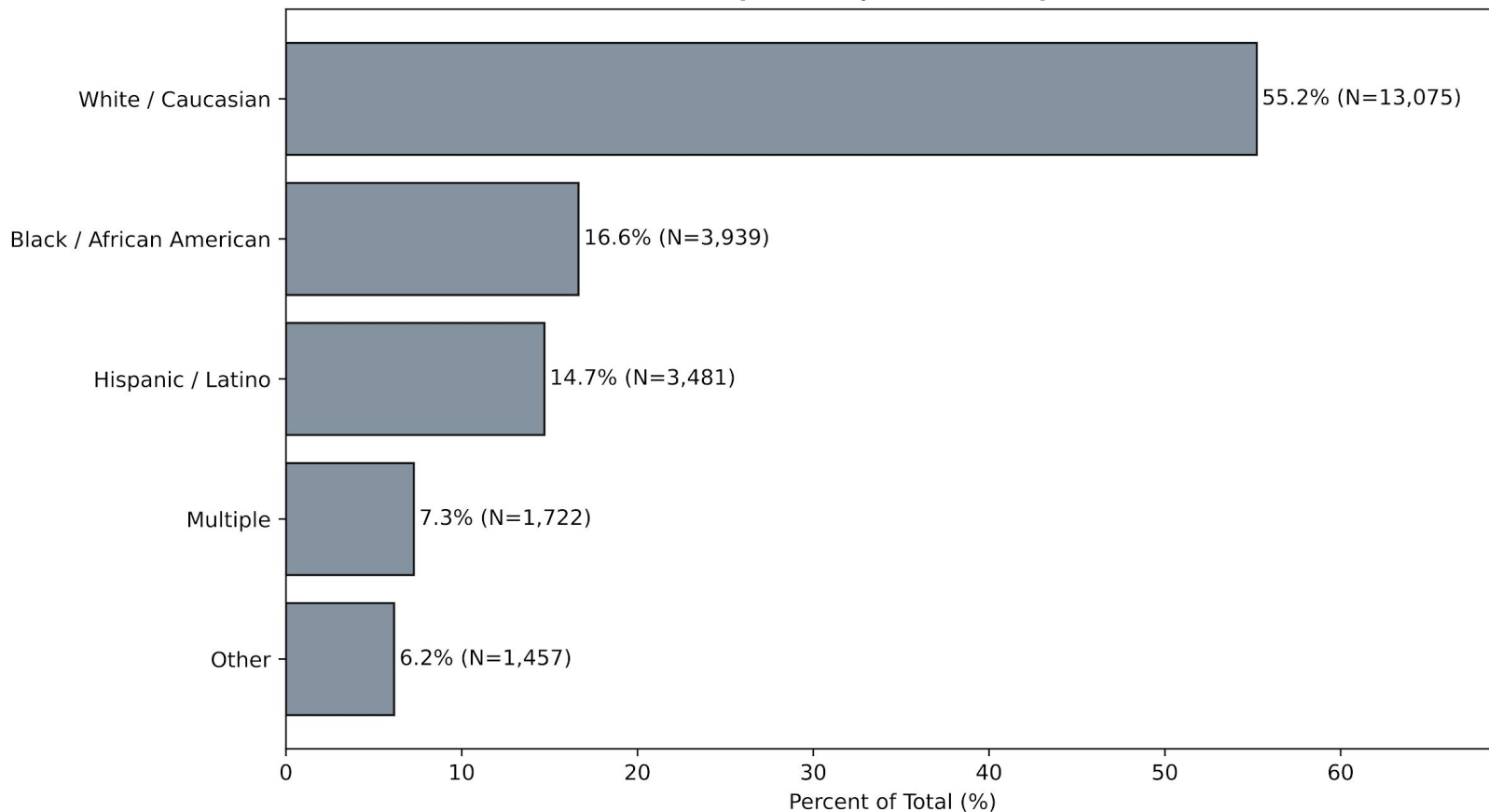
Cumulative NamUs Missing Person Cases by State (Continental U.S., 1969-2024)



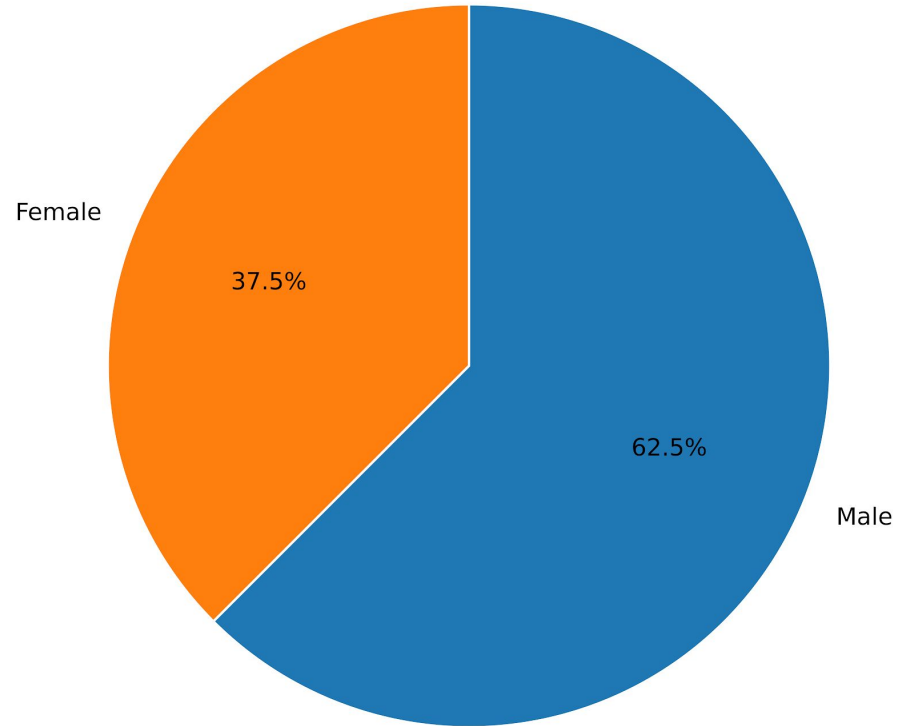
Age / Sex Distribution of Cumulative Missing Persons Cases [1969-2024]



Ethnicity Distribution of Cumulative NamUs Missing Persons[1969-2024] Cases (N = 23,674 cases)

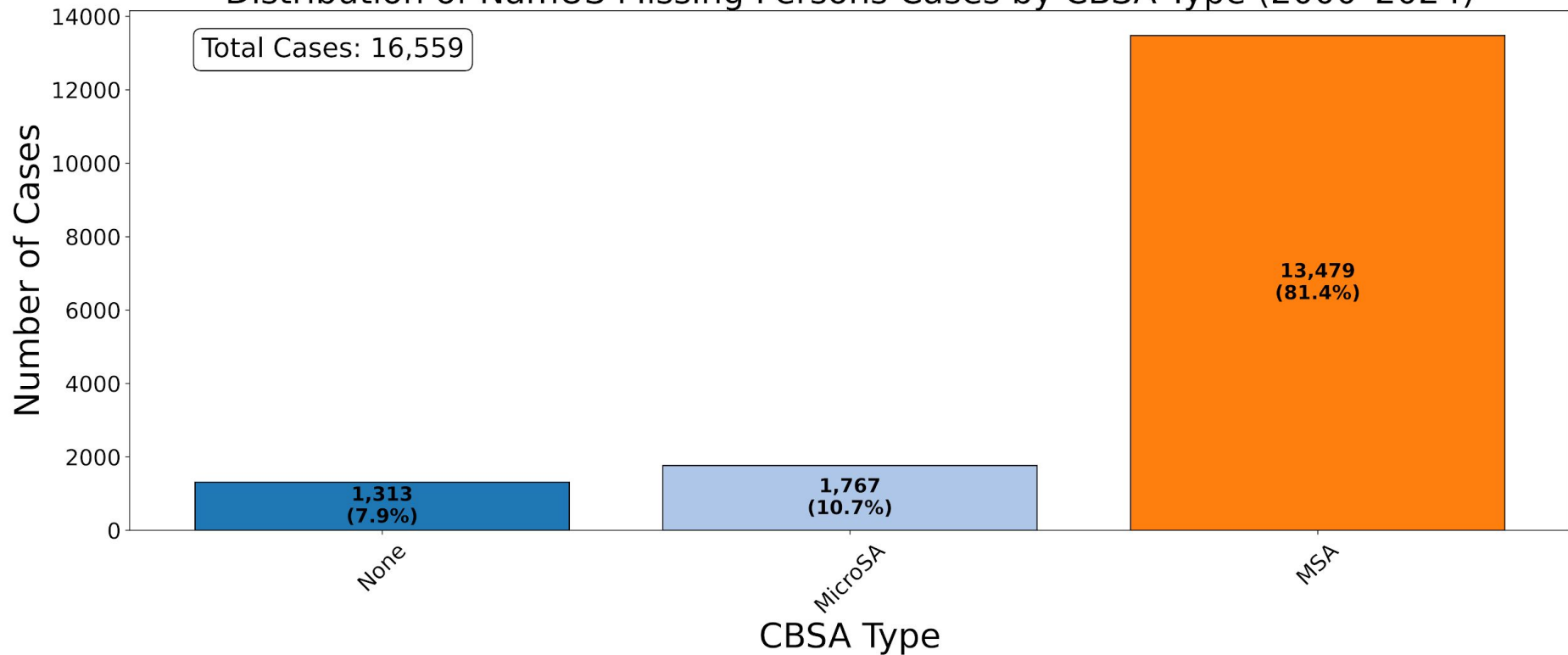


**Sex Distribution of Cumulative NamUs Missing Persons[1969-2024] Cases
(N = 23,674 cases)**

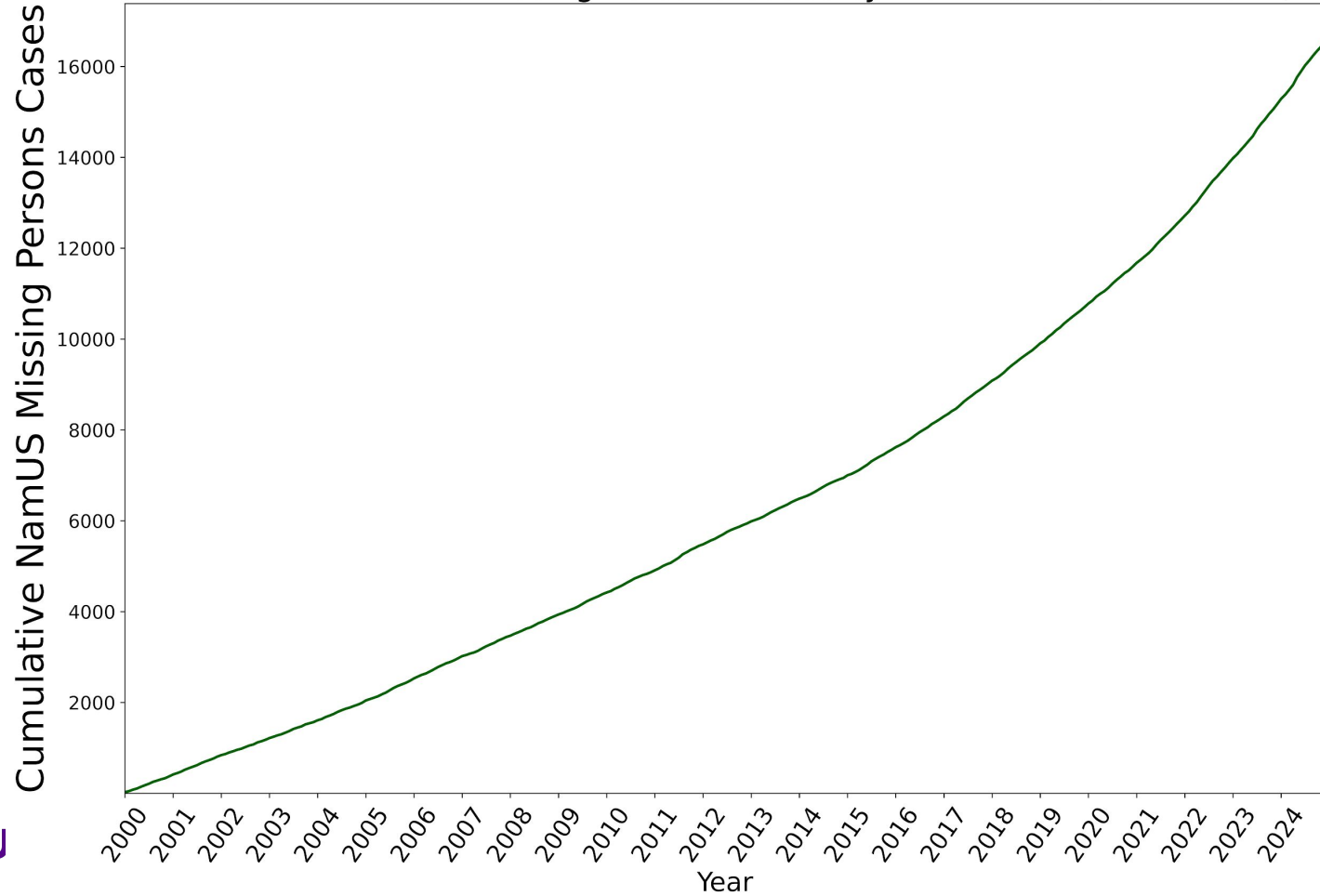


NamUs Cases [2000-2024]

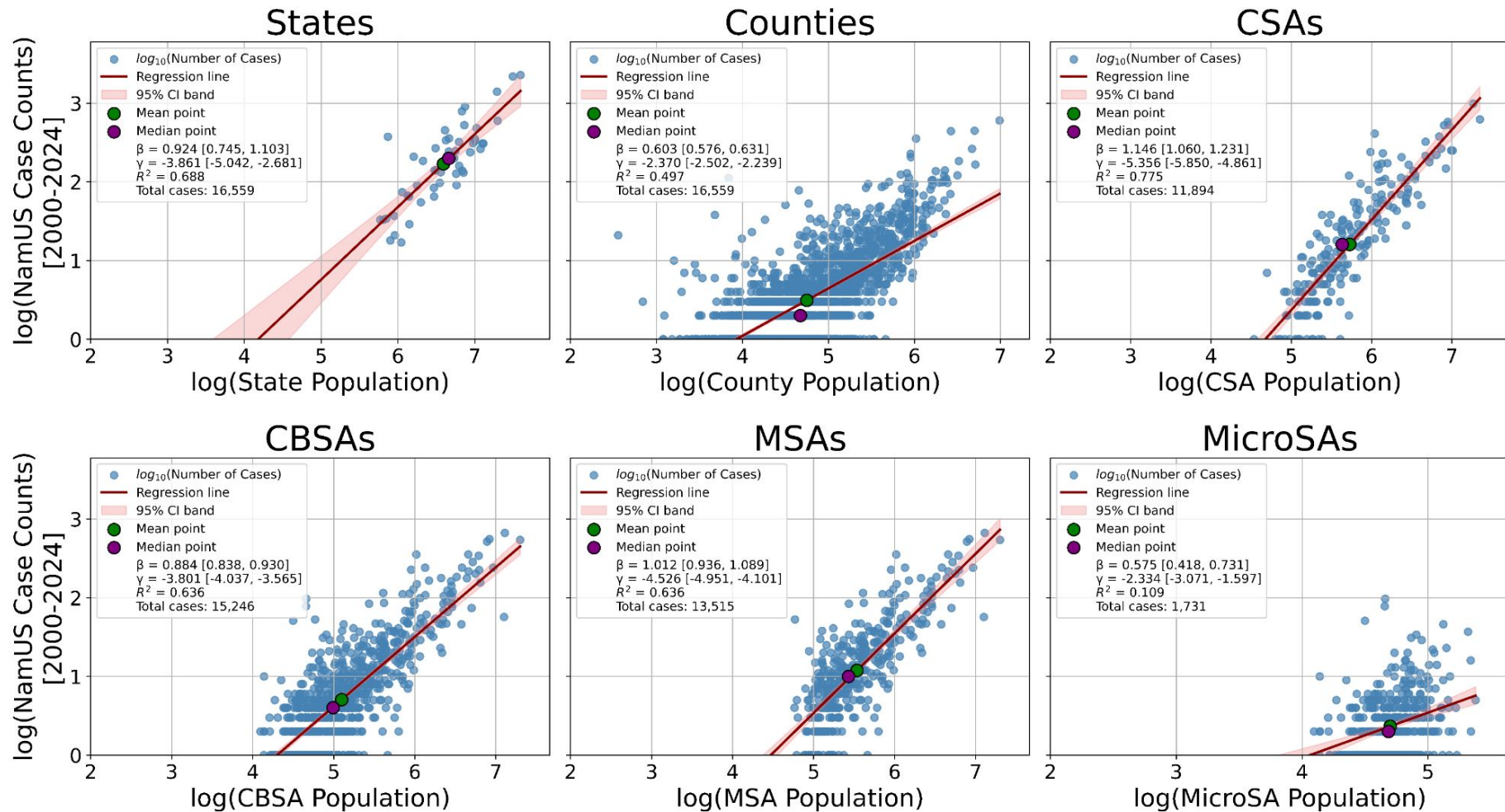
Distribution of NamUS Missing Persons Cases by CBSA Type (2000-2024)



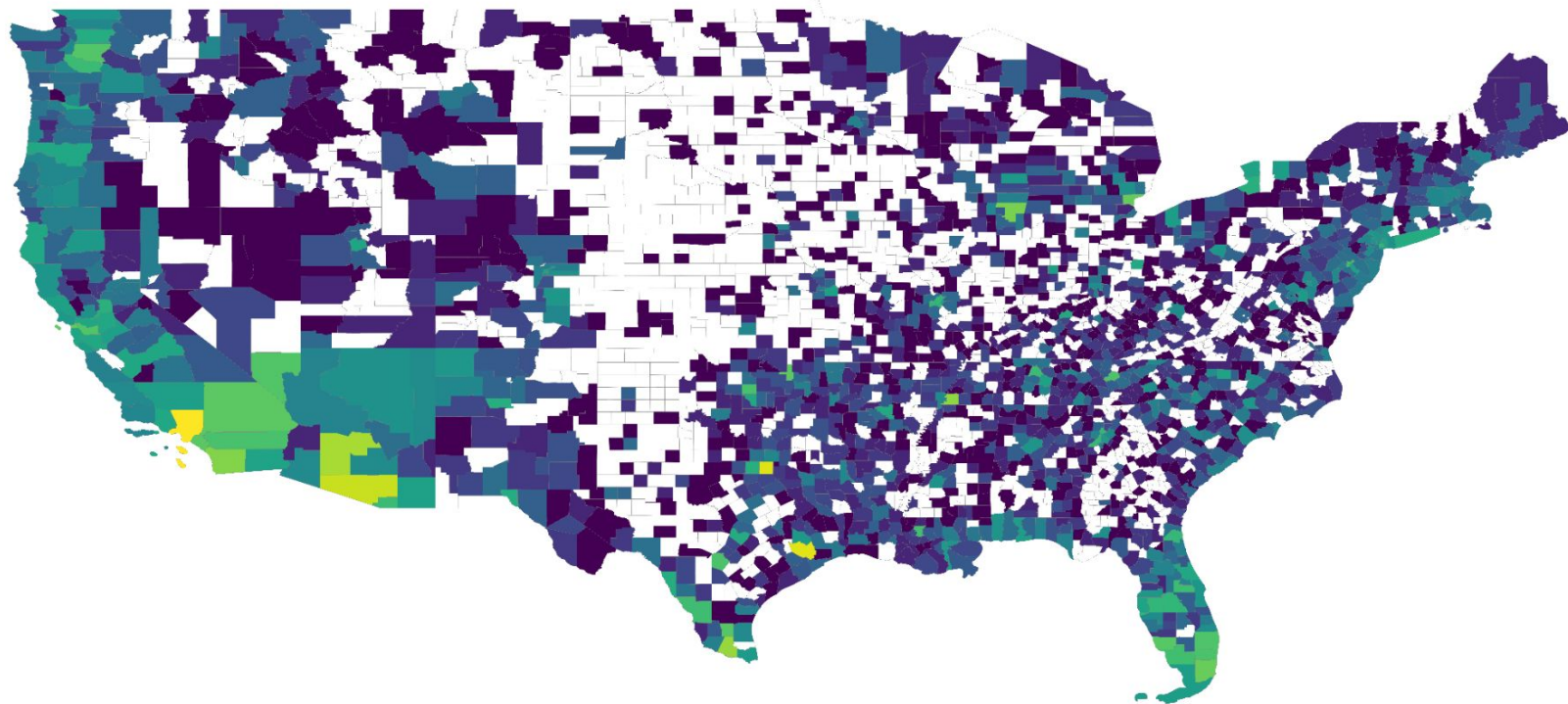
Cumulative NamUS Missing Persons Cases by Month Start (2000-2024)



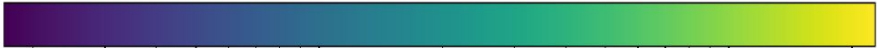
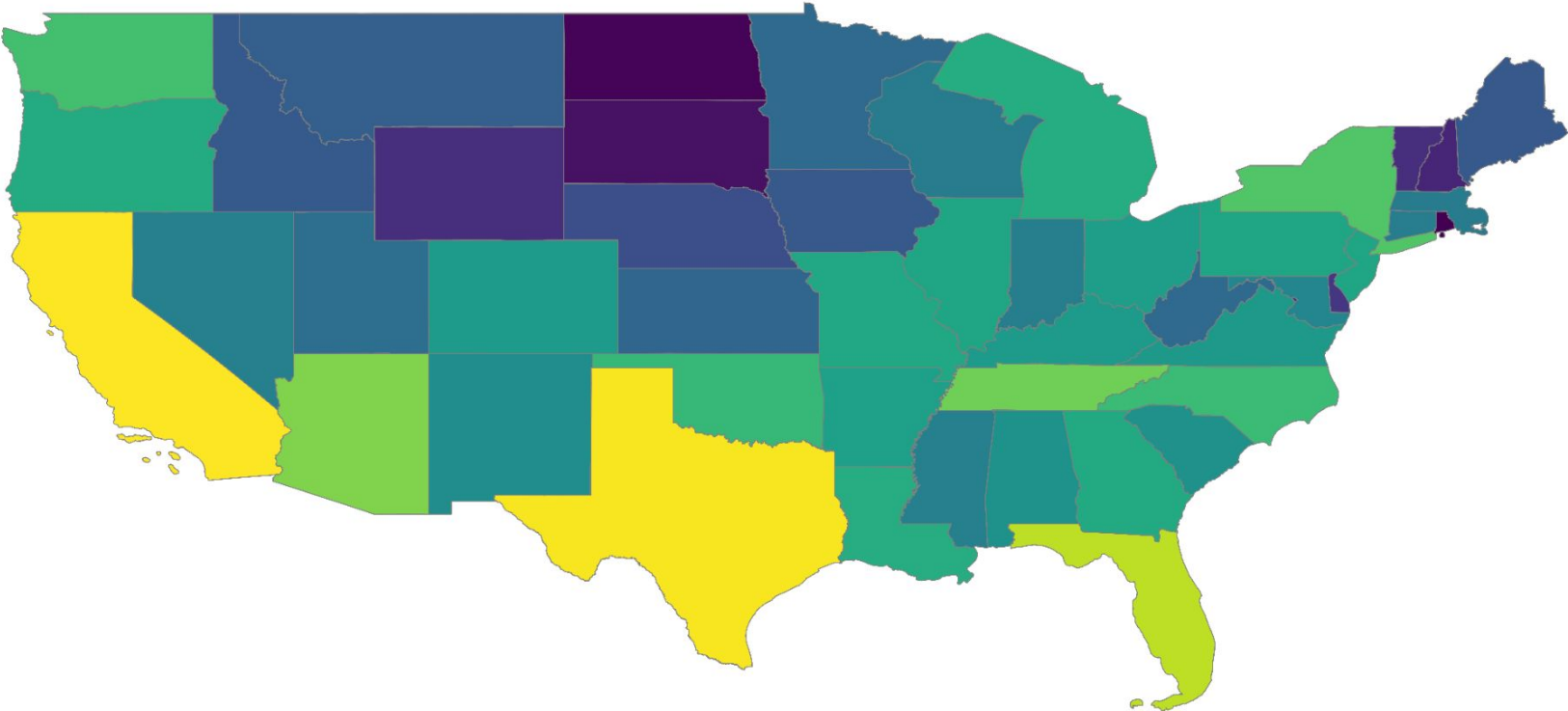
Scaling Exponent (β) of NamUS Missing Persons Cases vs GEOID Population [2000-2024]



Cumulative NamUs Missing Person Cases by County (Continental U.S., 2000-2024)

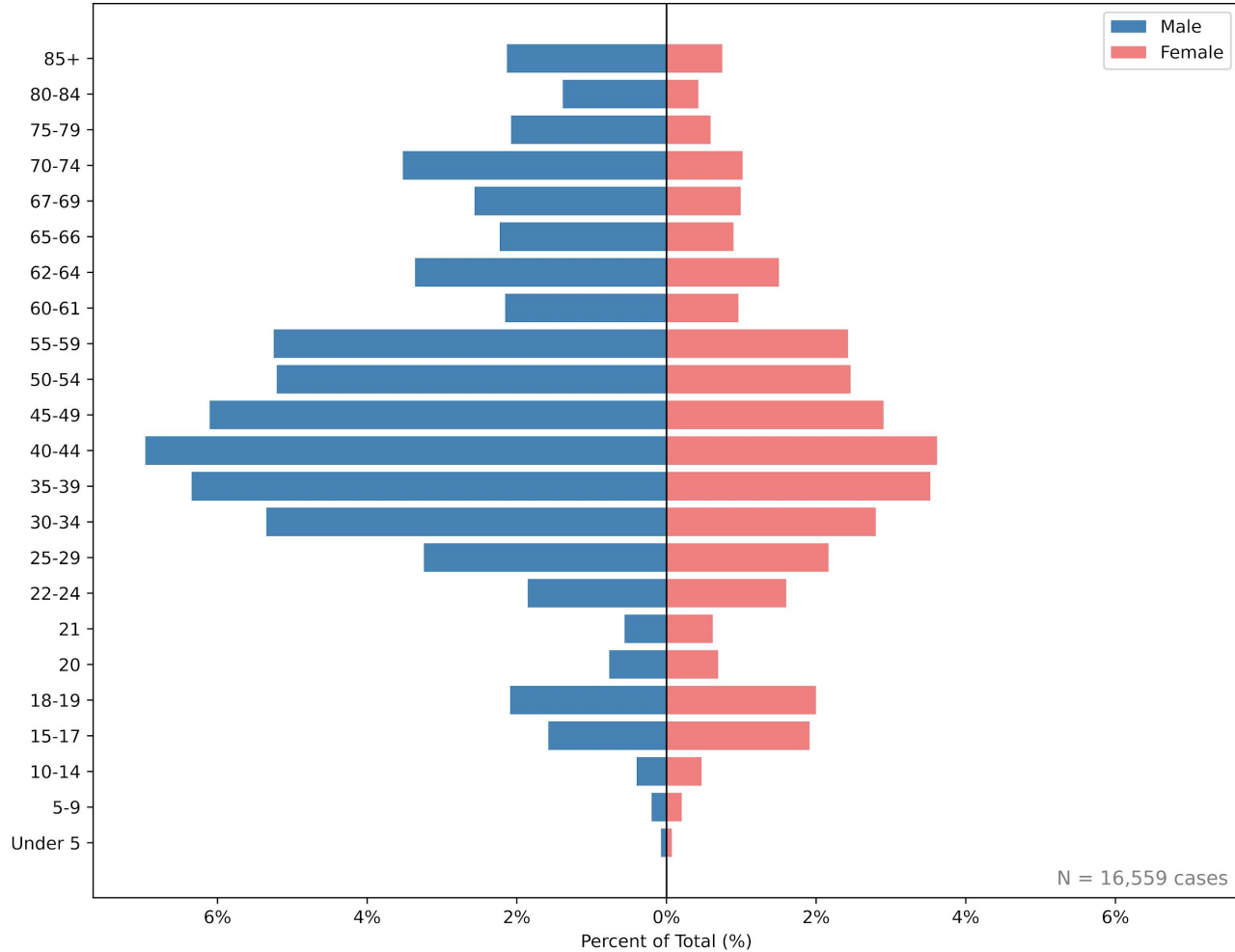


Cumulative NamUs Missing Person Cases by State (Continental U.S., 2000-2024)

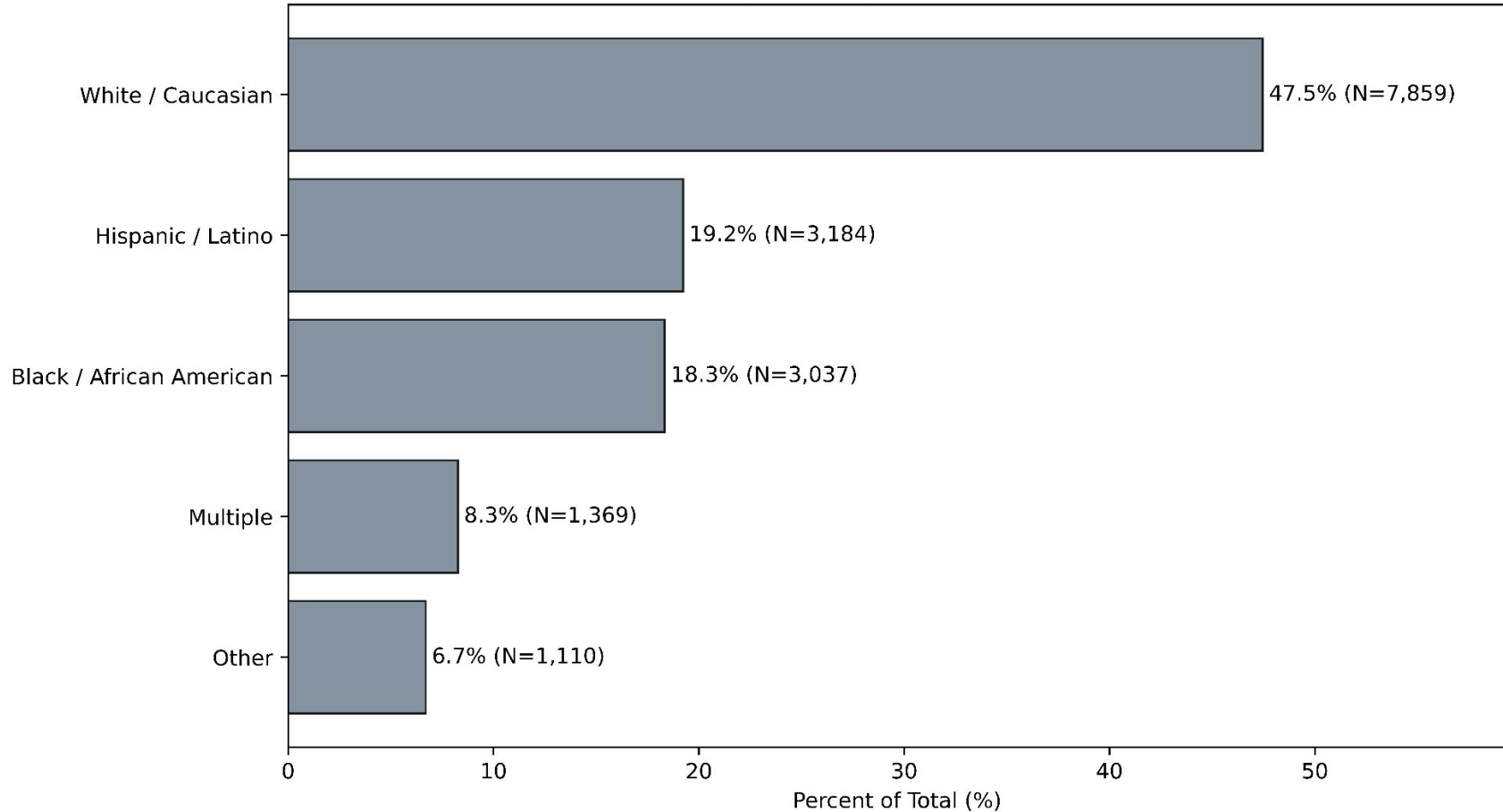


$\log_{10}(\text{Cumulative Missing Person Cases})$ (2000-2024)

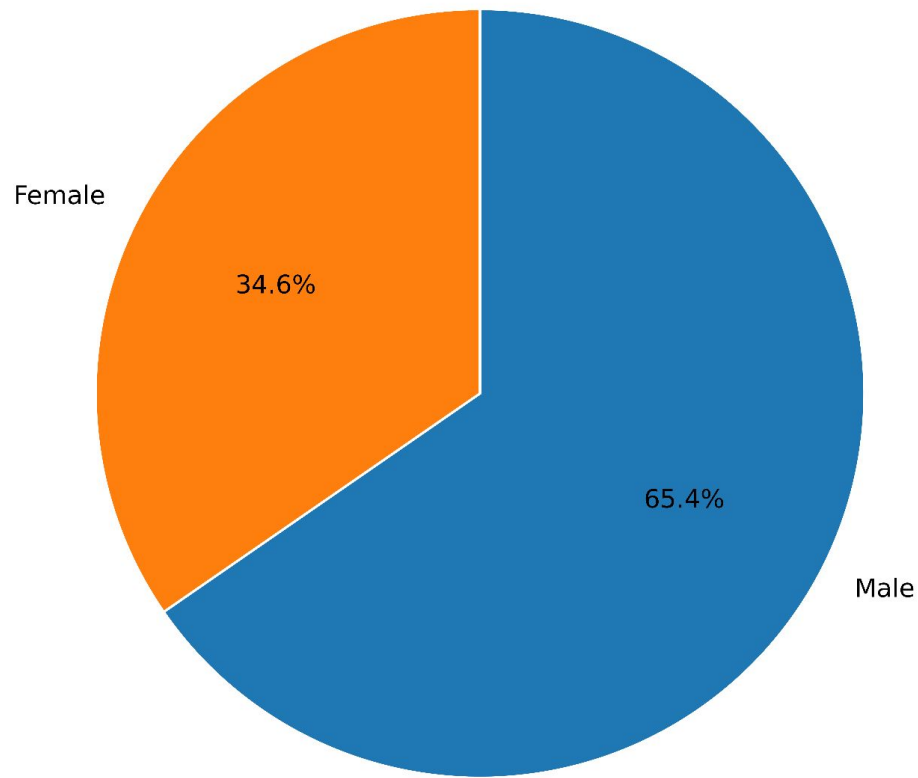
Age / Sex Distribution of Cumulative Missing Persons Cases [2000-2024]



Ethnicity Distribution of Cumulative NamUs Missing Persons [2000-2024] Cases (N = 16,559 cases)

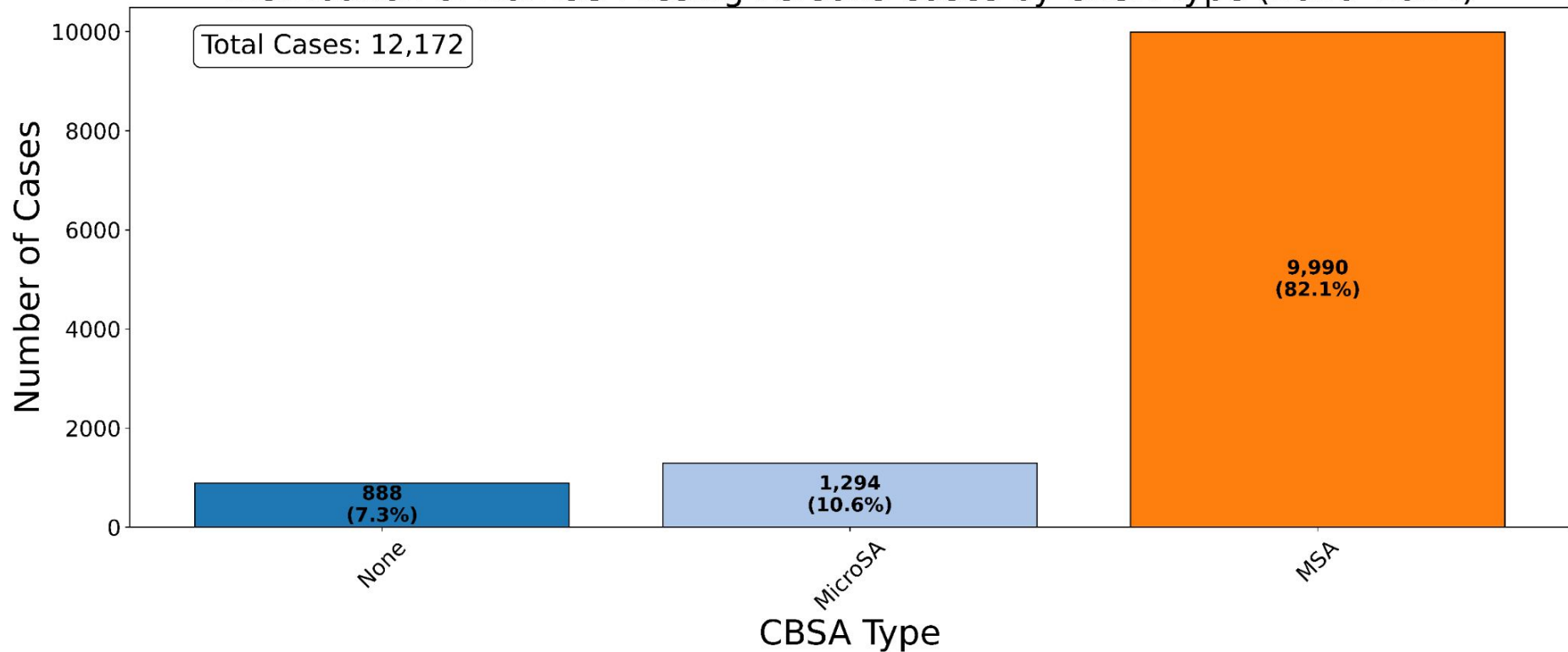


Sex Distribution of Cumulative NamUs Missing Persons [2000-2024] Cases (N = 16,559 cases)



NamUs Cases [2010-2024]

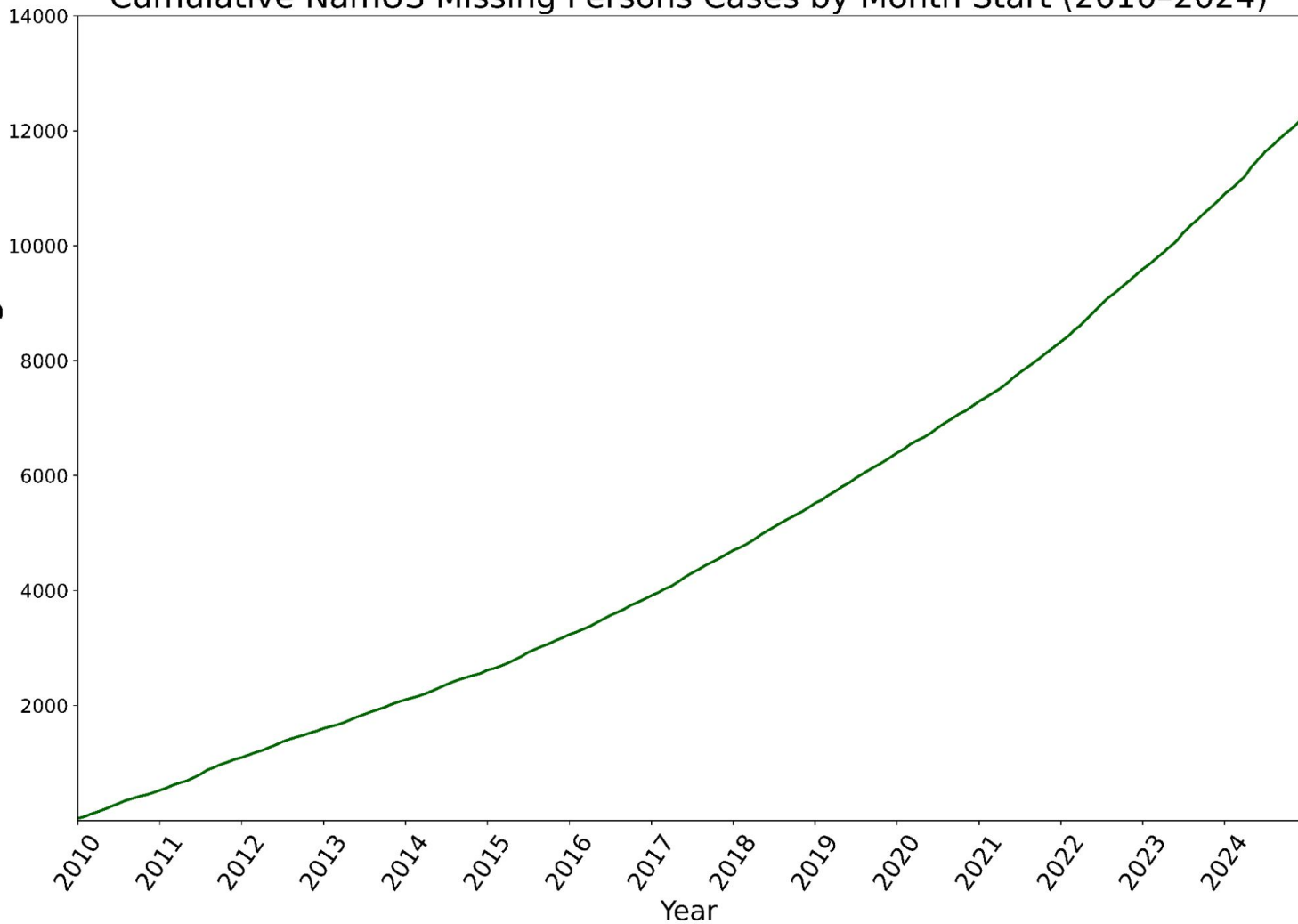
Distribution of NamUS Missing Persons Cases by CBSA Type (2010-2024)



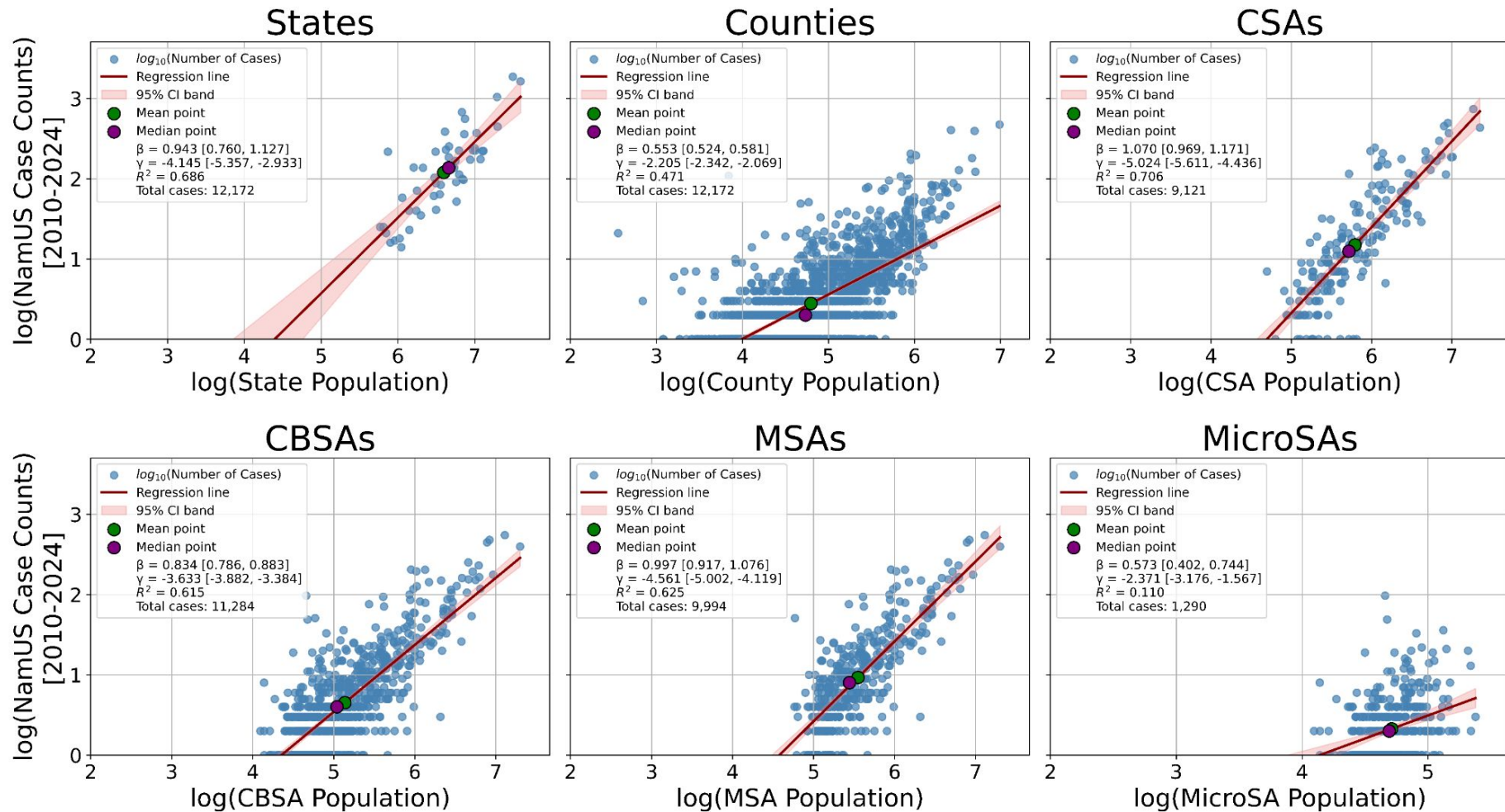


Cumulative NamUS Missing Persons Cases

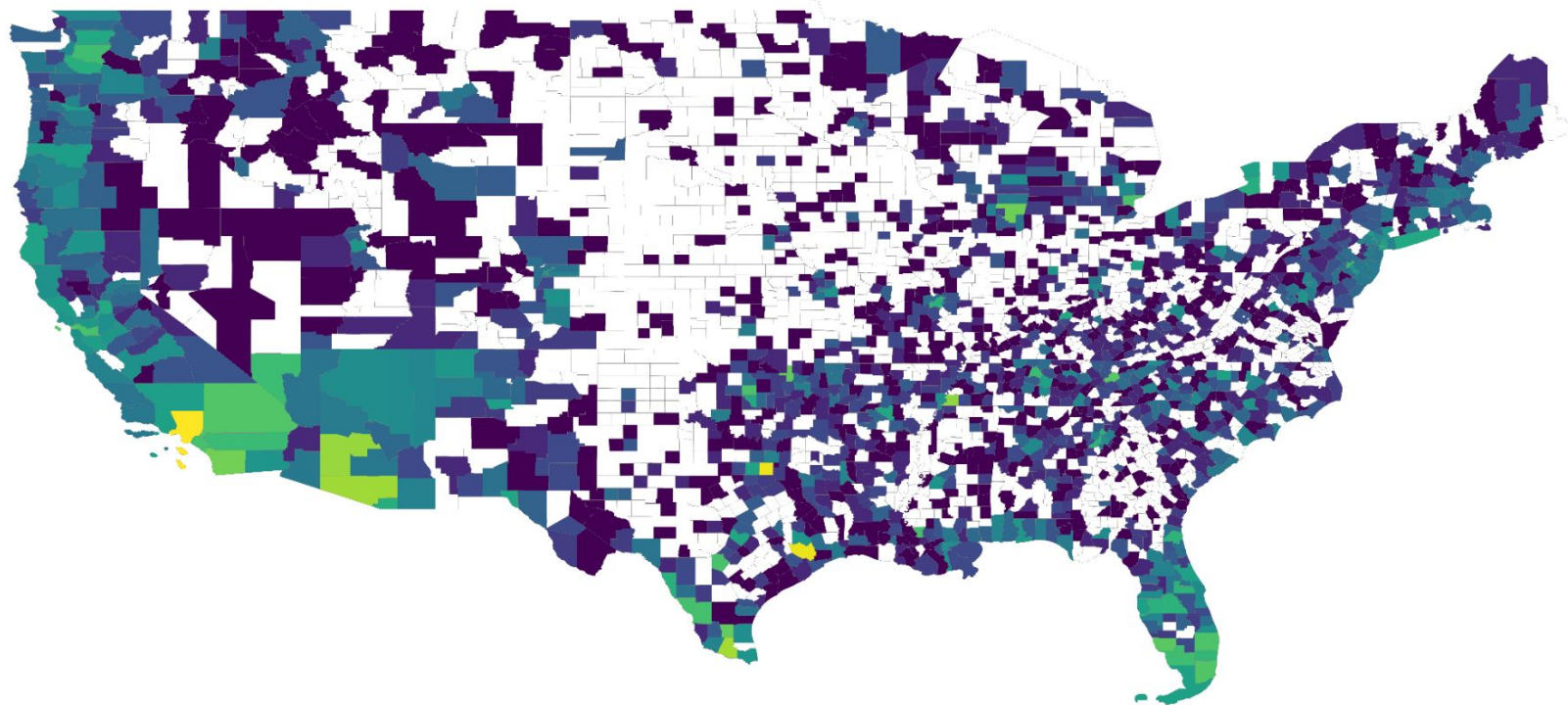
Cumulative NamUS Missing Persons Cases by Month Start (2010-2024)



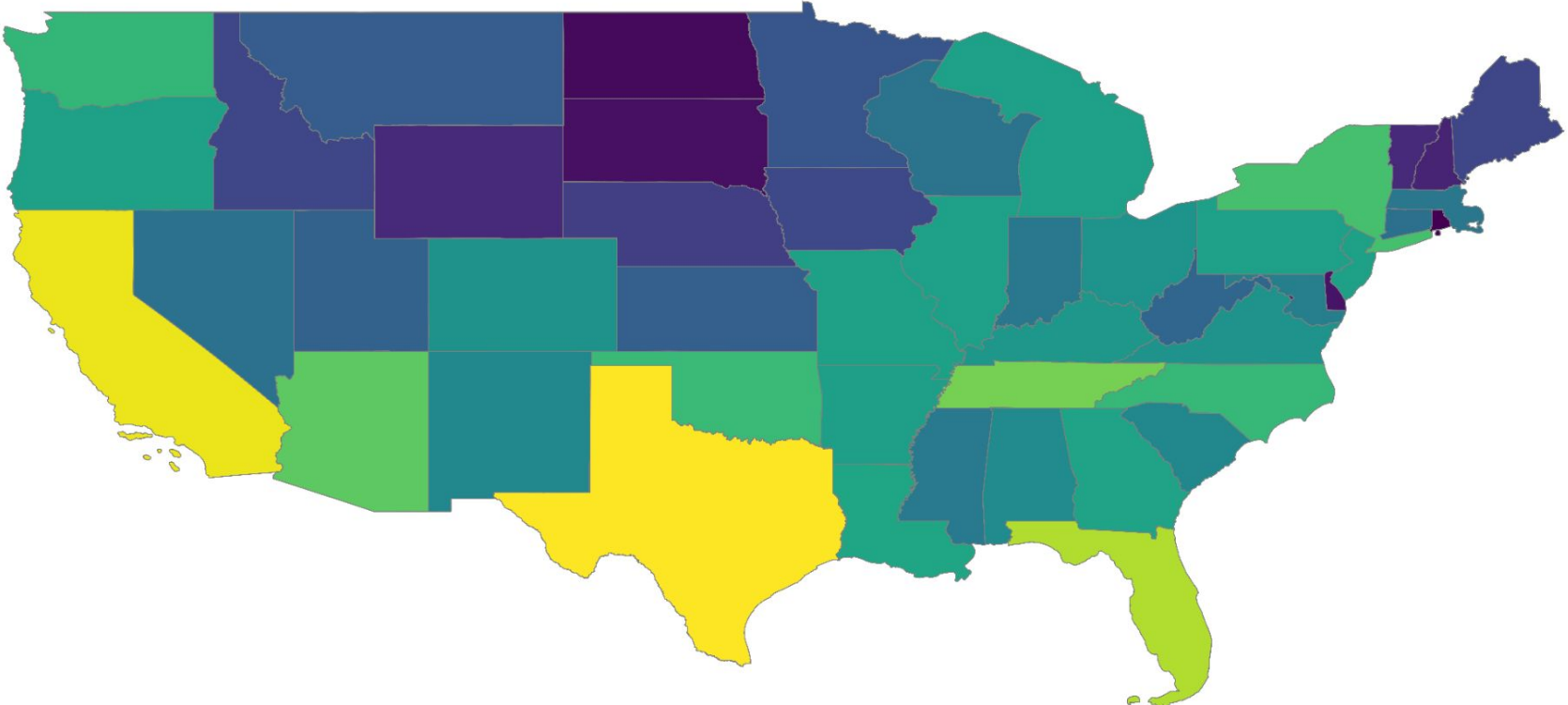
Scaling Exponent (β) of NamUS Missing Persons Cases vs GEOID Population [2010-2024]



Cumulative NamUs Missing Person Cases by County (Continental U.S., 2010-2024)

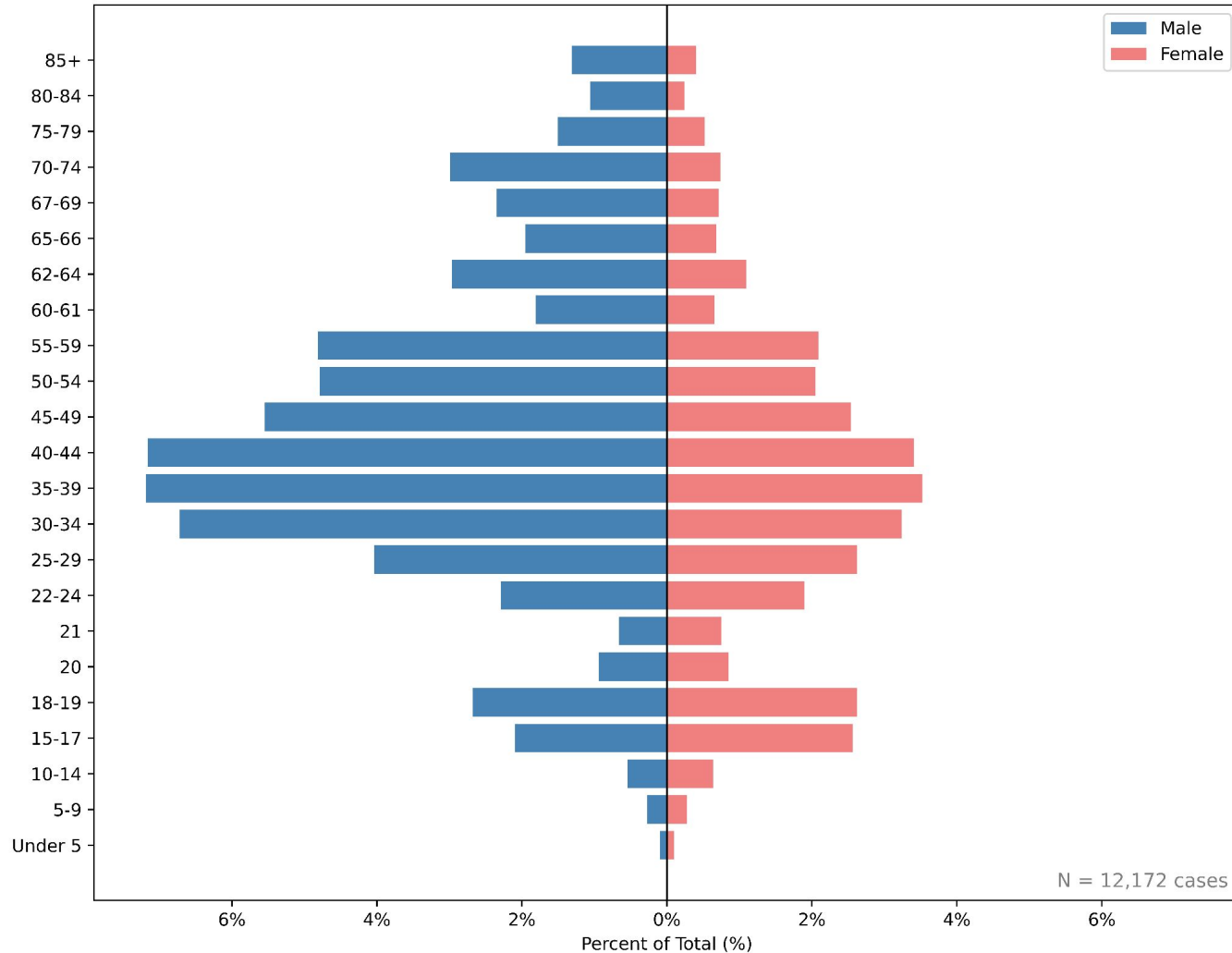


Cumulative NamUs Missing Person Cases by State (Continental U.S., 2010-2024)

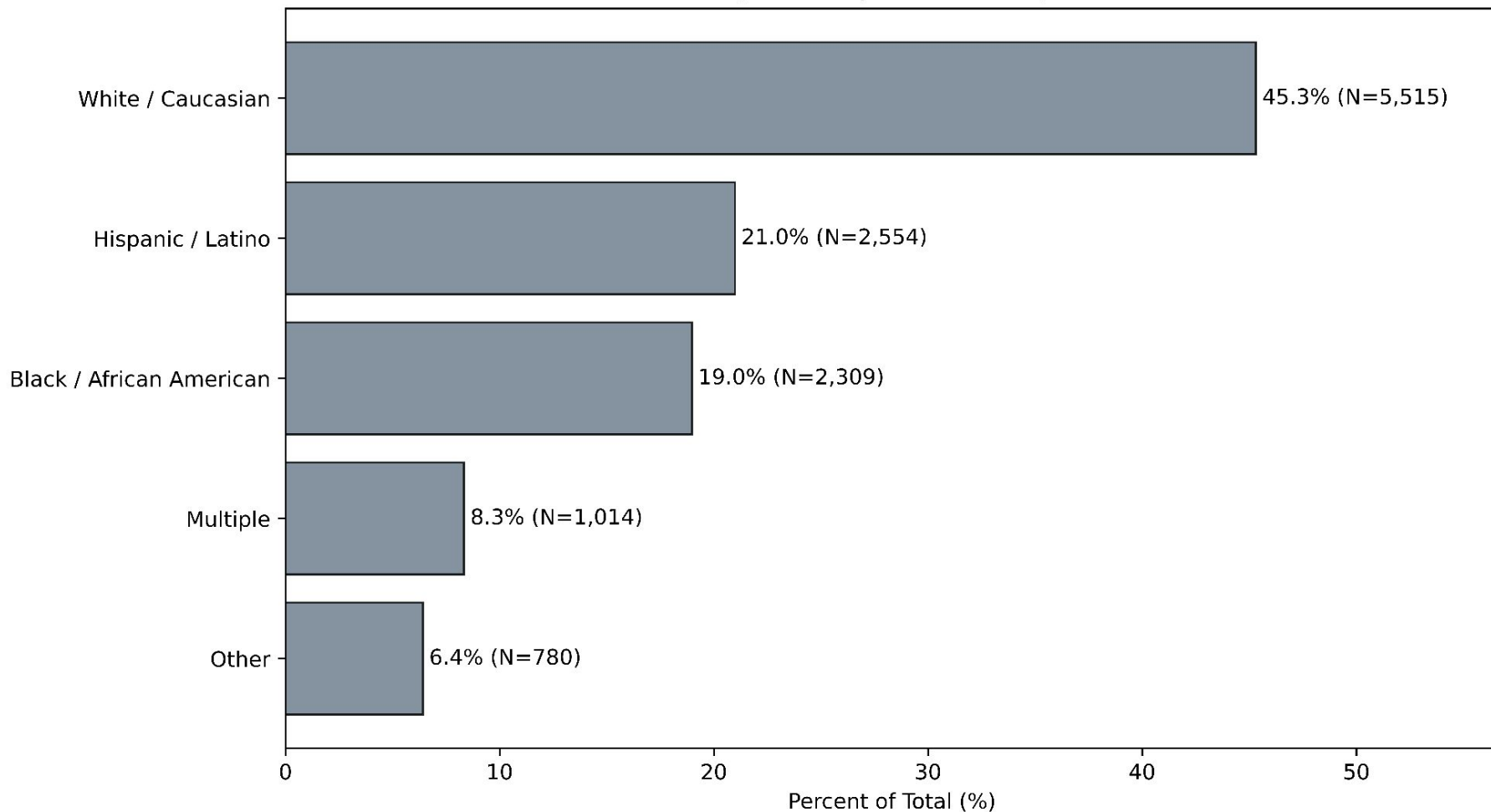


$\log_{10}(\text{Cumulative Missing Person Cases}) (2010-2024)$

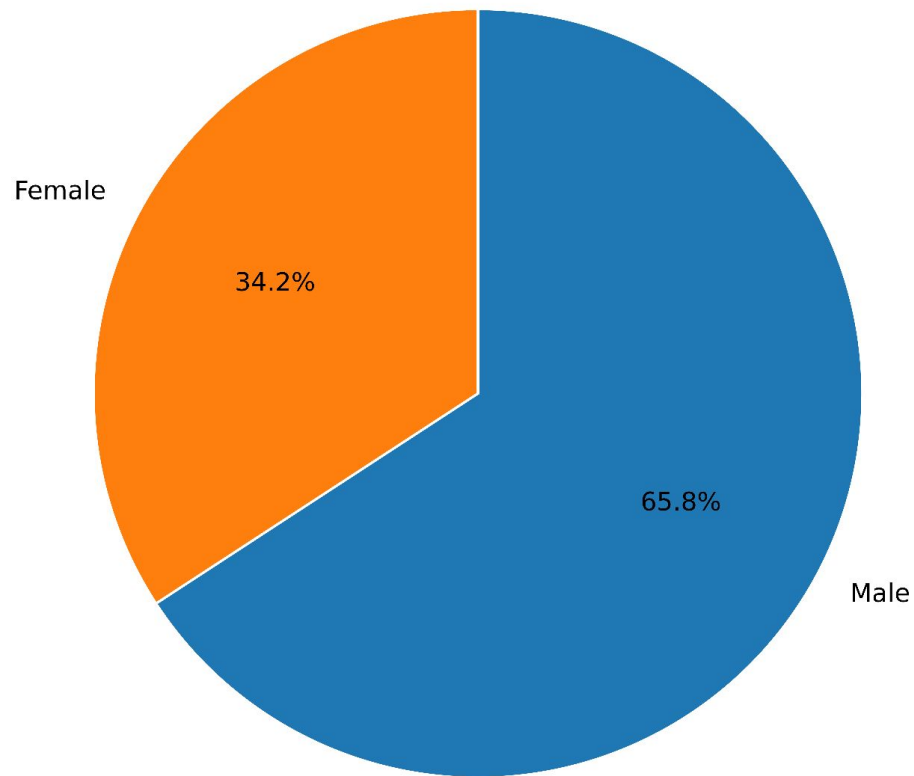
Age / Sex Distribution of Cumulative Missing Persons Cases [2010-2024]



Ethnicity Distribution of Cumulative NamUs Missing Persons [2010-2024] Cases (N = 12,172 cases)



Sex Distribution of Cumulative NamUs Missing Persons [2010-2024] Cases (N = 12,172 cases)



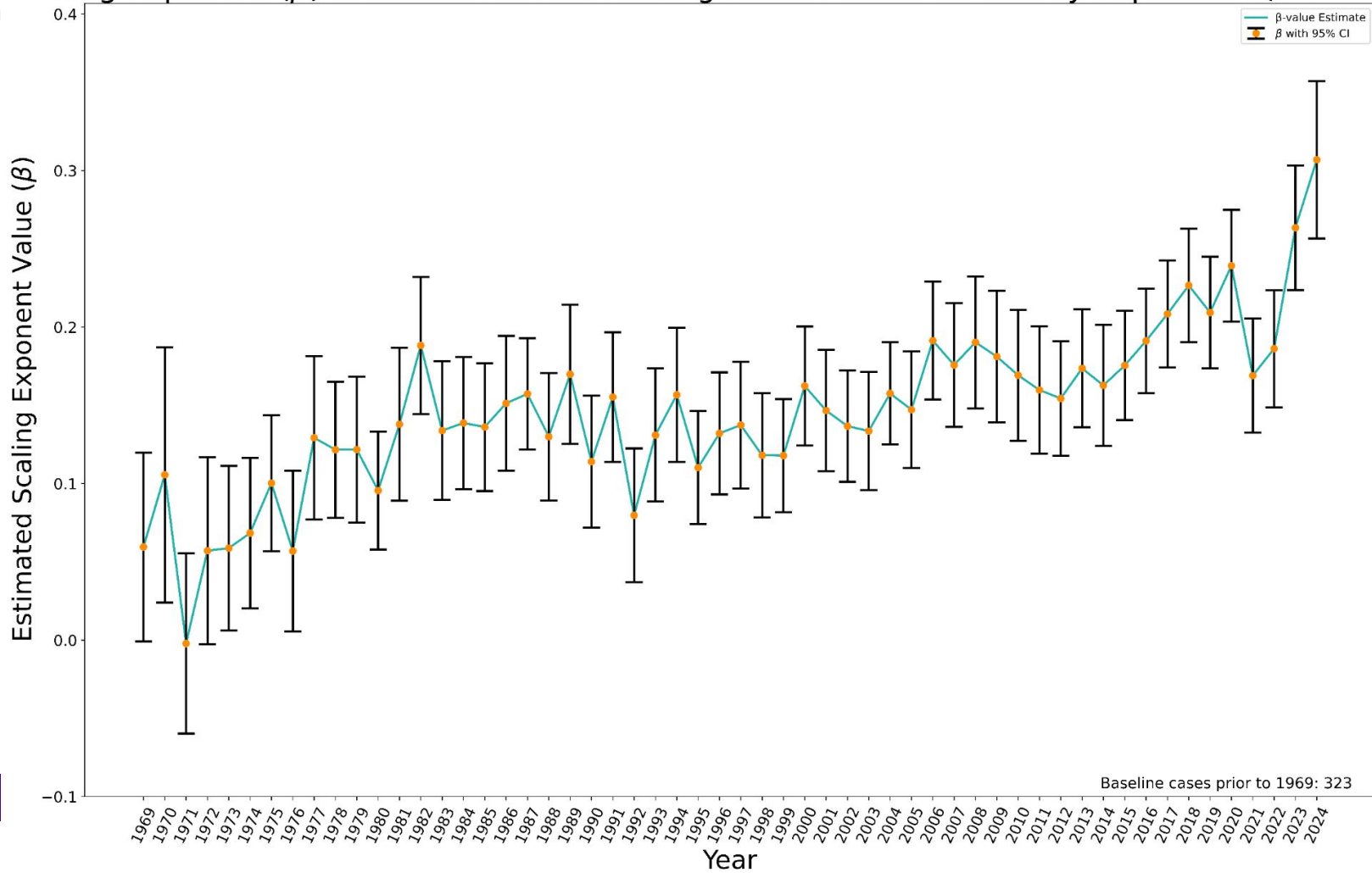
Annual NamUs Cases

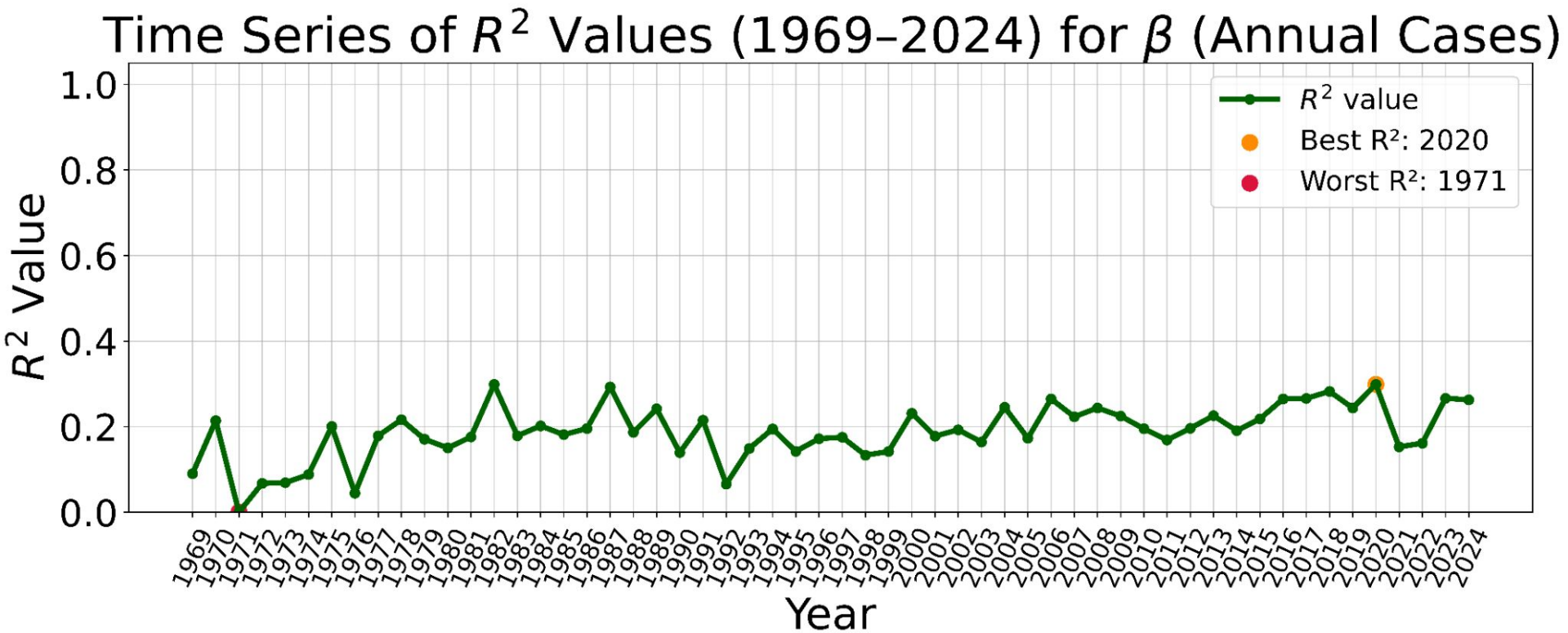
- Time-series of Scaling Exponent of Annual Cases vs GEOID Population from [1969-2024]
 - Counties
 - CSAs
 - CBSAs; MSAs and MicroSAs
- R-squared Time Series [1969-2024]
- Best and Worst Year R-squared Regression Plots

County-level

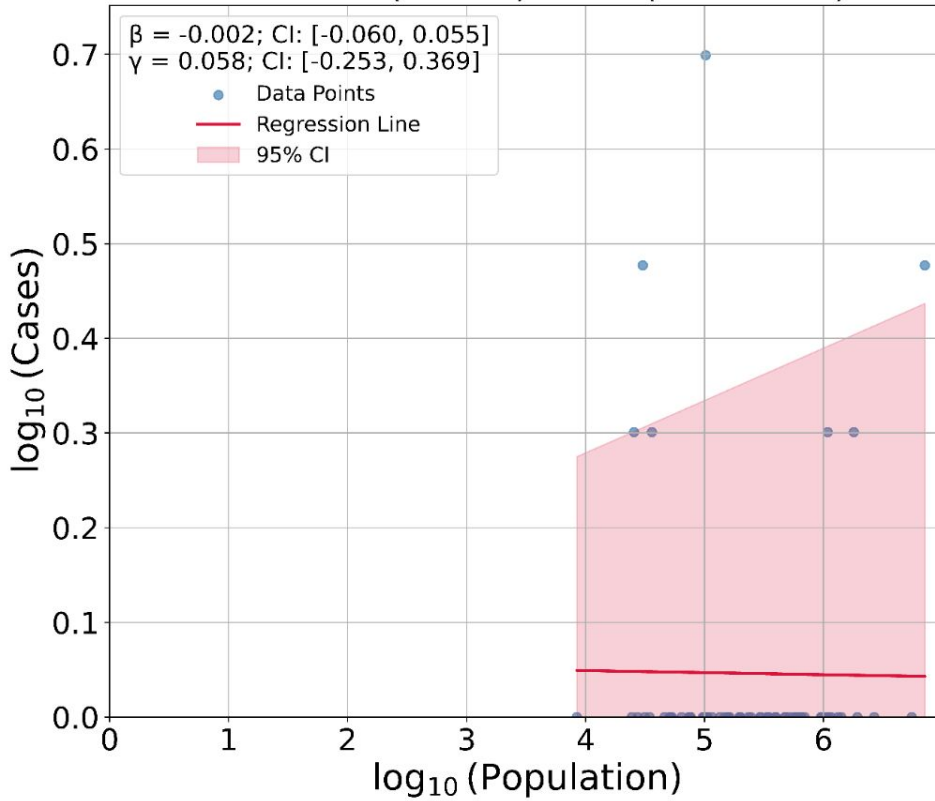
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Scaling Exponent (β) of Annual NamUS Missing Person Cases vs County Population (1969–2024)

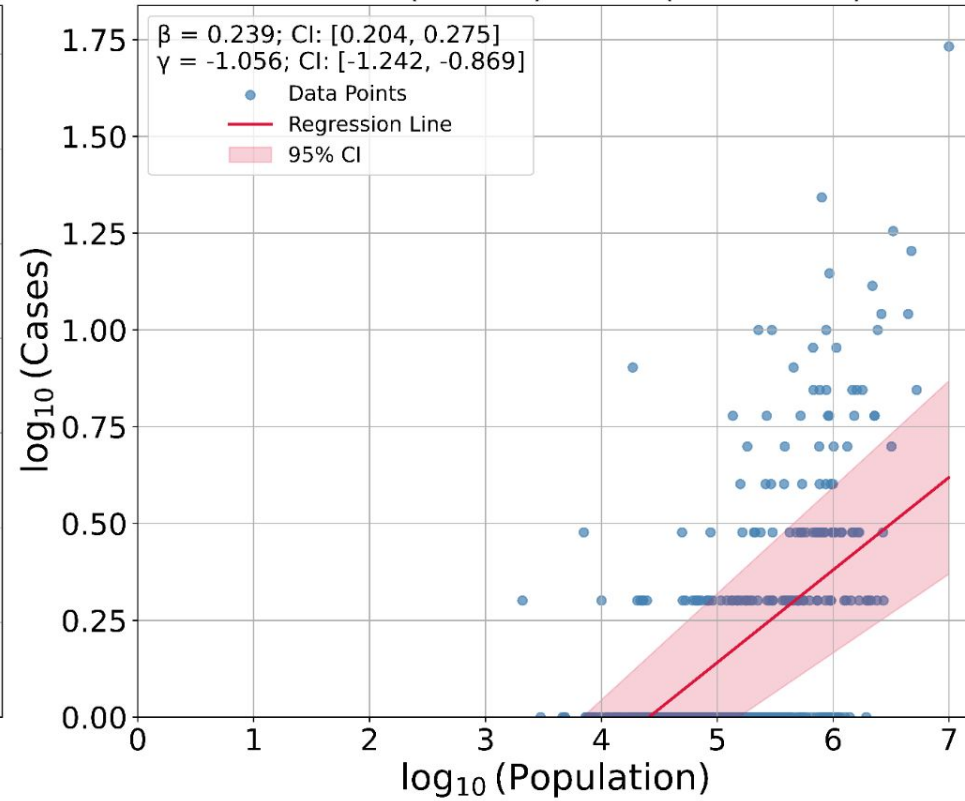




Worst Year (Annual): 1971 ($R^2 = 0.000$)

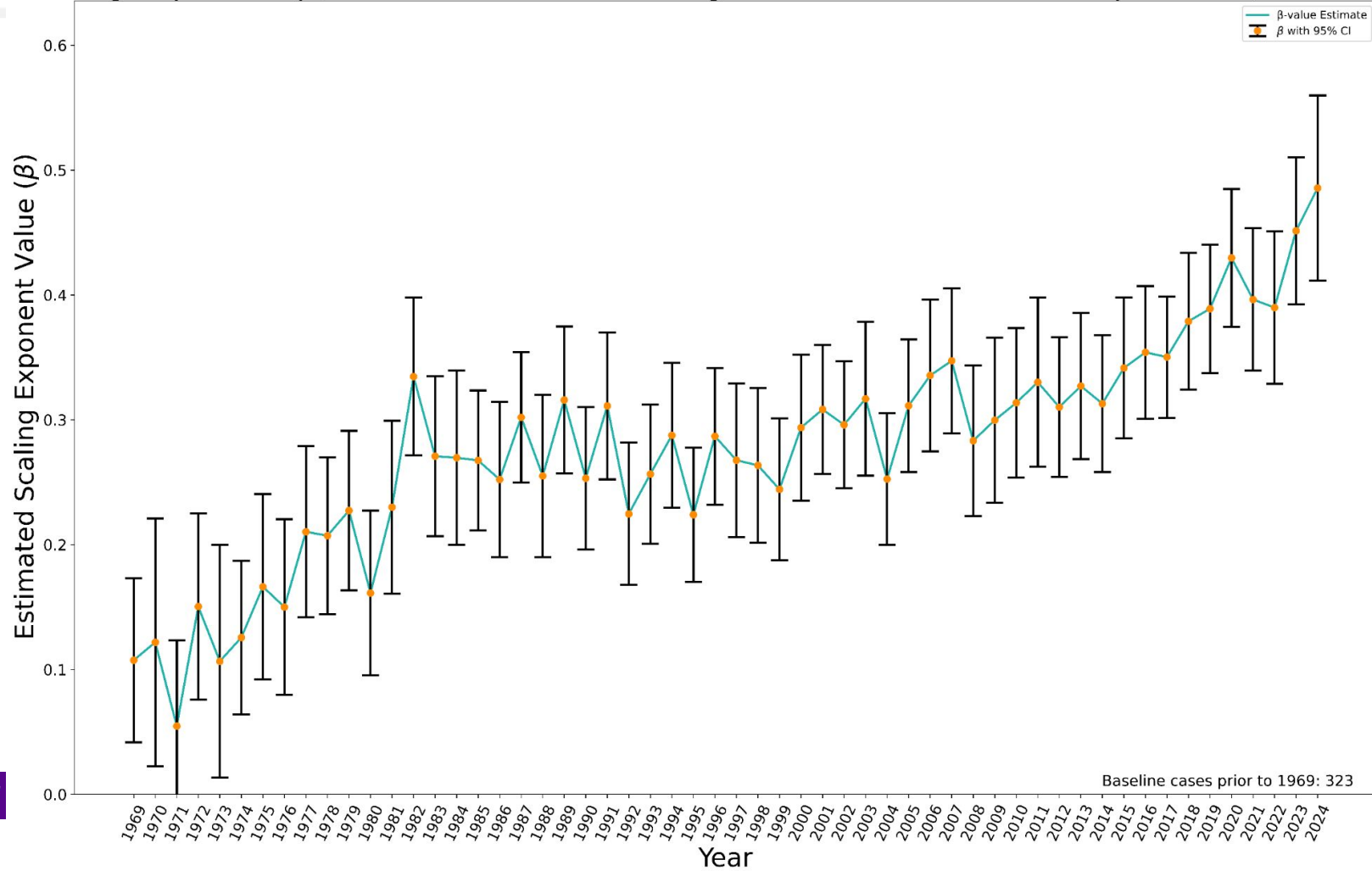


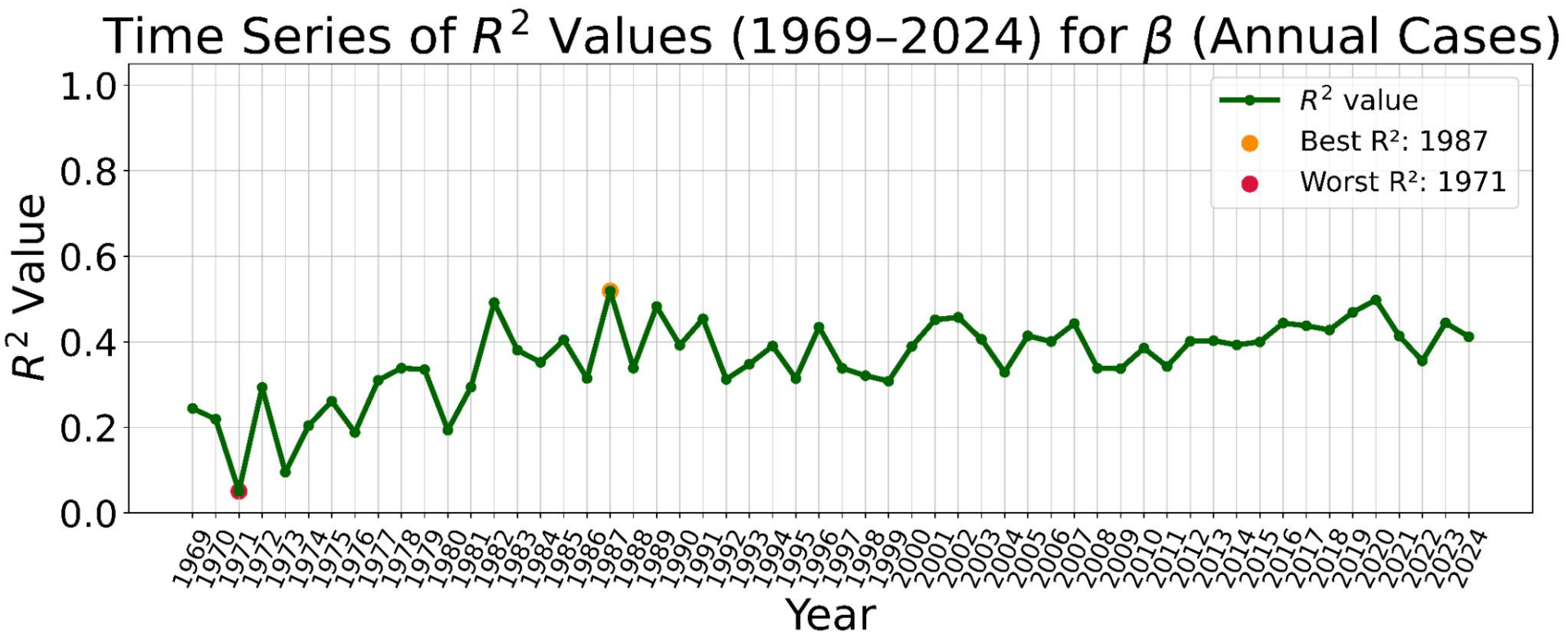
Best Year (Annual): 2020 ($R^2 = 0.299$)



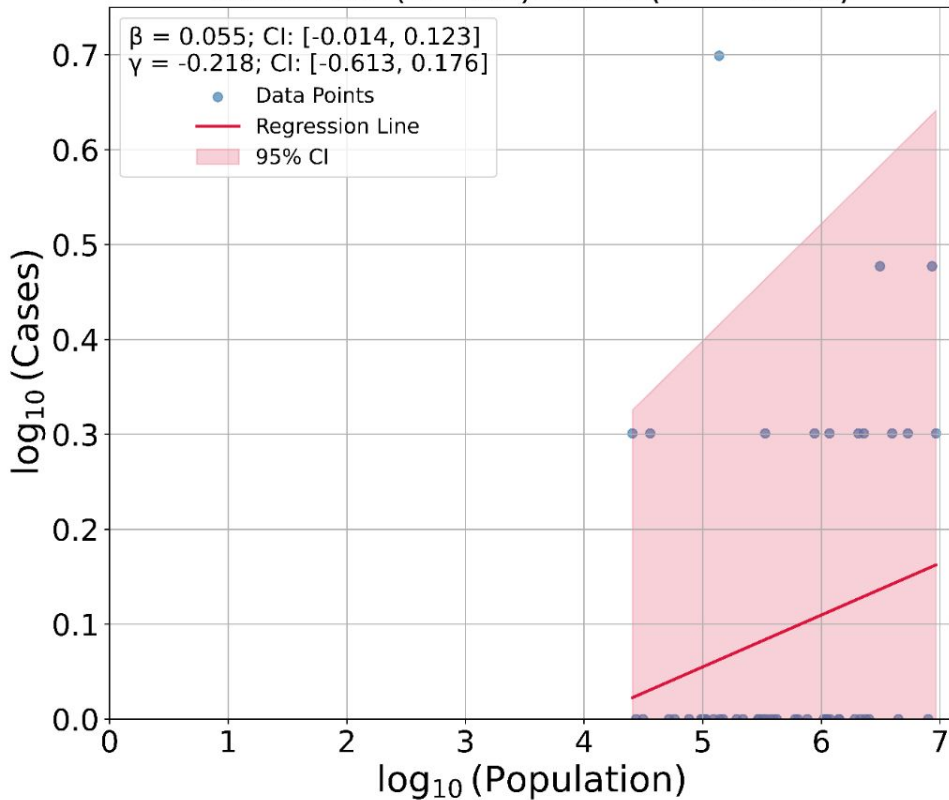
CBSA-level

Scaling Exponent (β) of Annual NamUS Missing Person Cases vs CBSA Population (1969–2024)

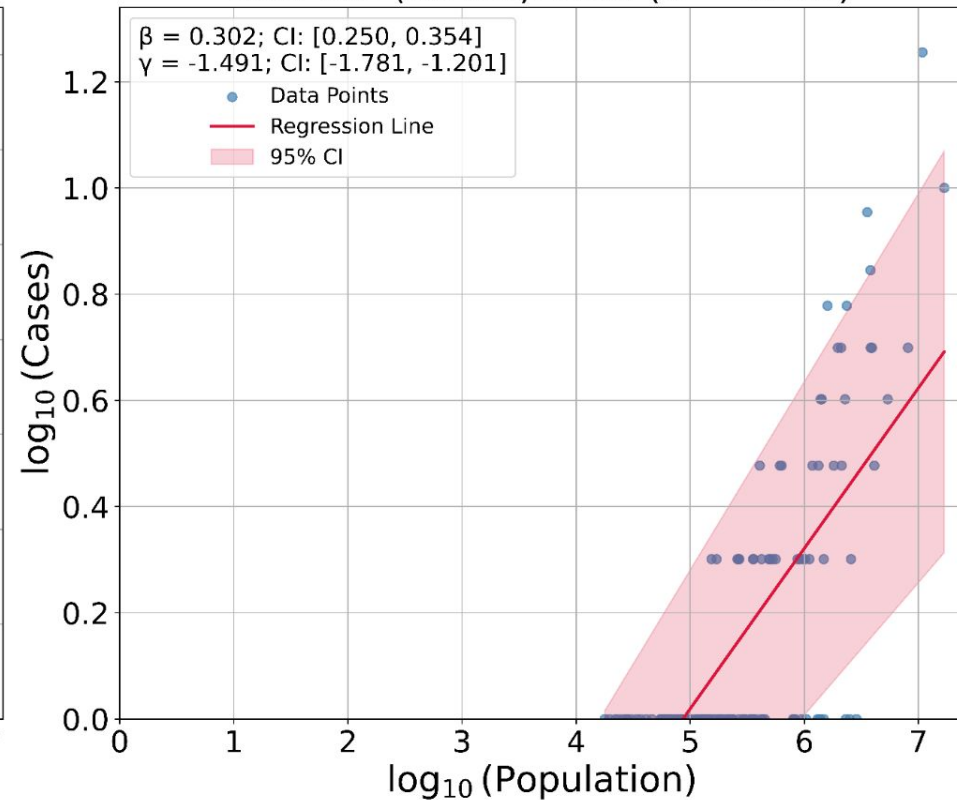




Worst Year (Annual): 1971 ($R^2 = 0.051$)



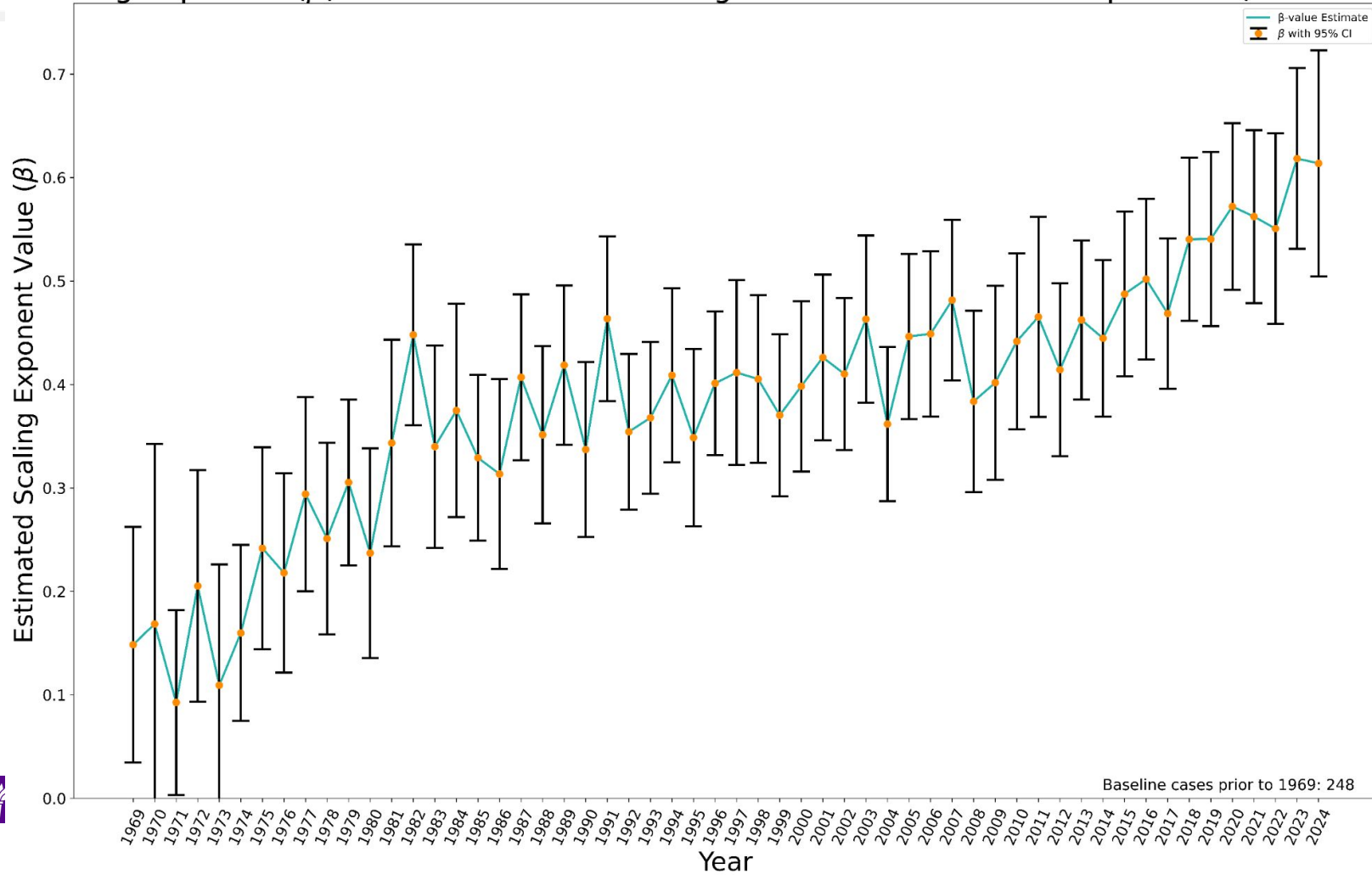
Best Year (Annual): 1987 ($R^2 = 0.519$)

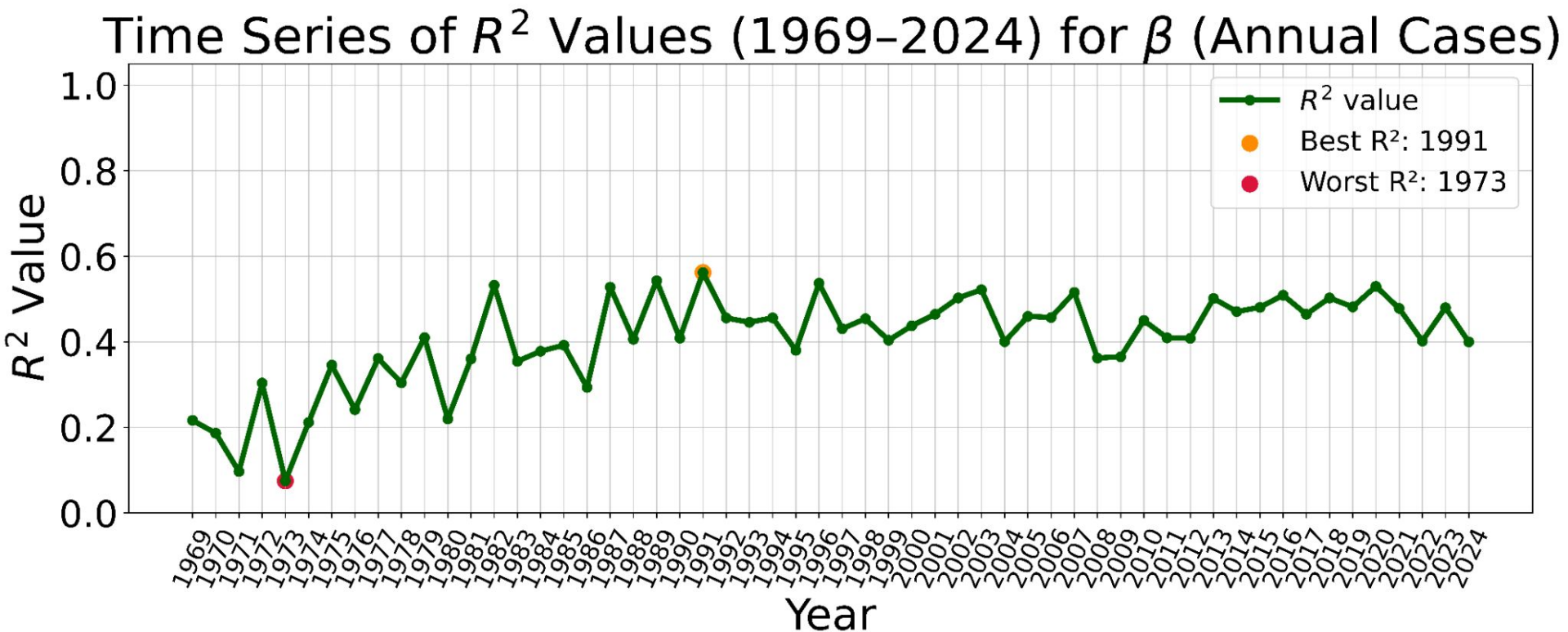


MSA-level

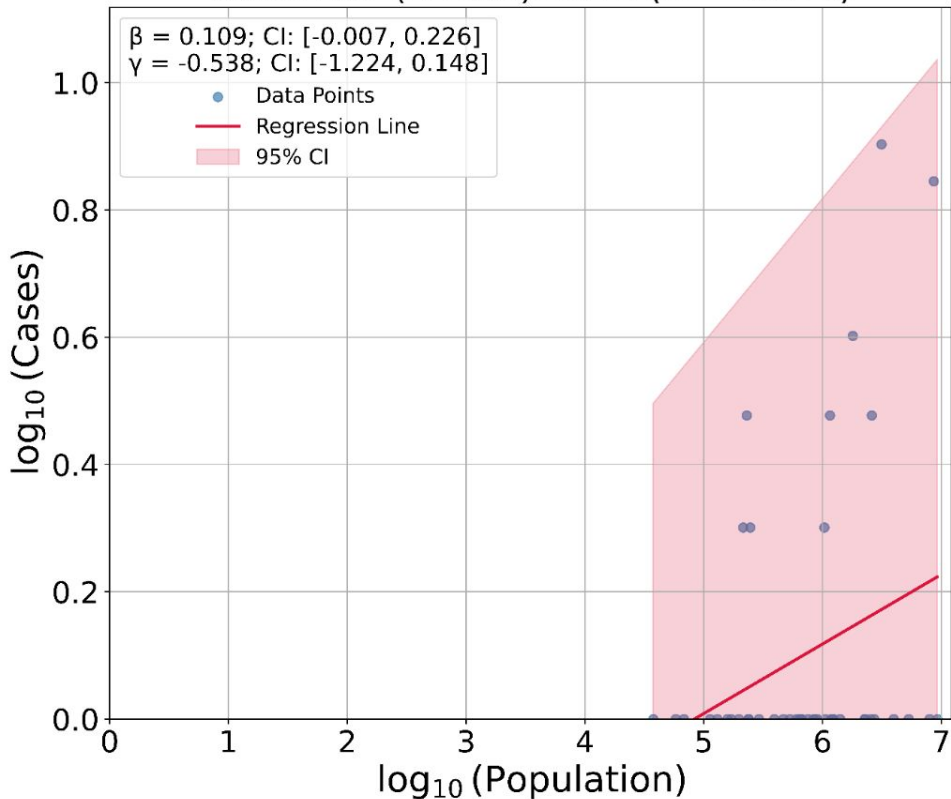
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Scaling Exponent (β) of Annual NamUS Missing Person Cases vs MSA Population (1969–2024)

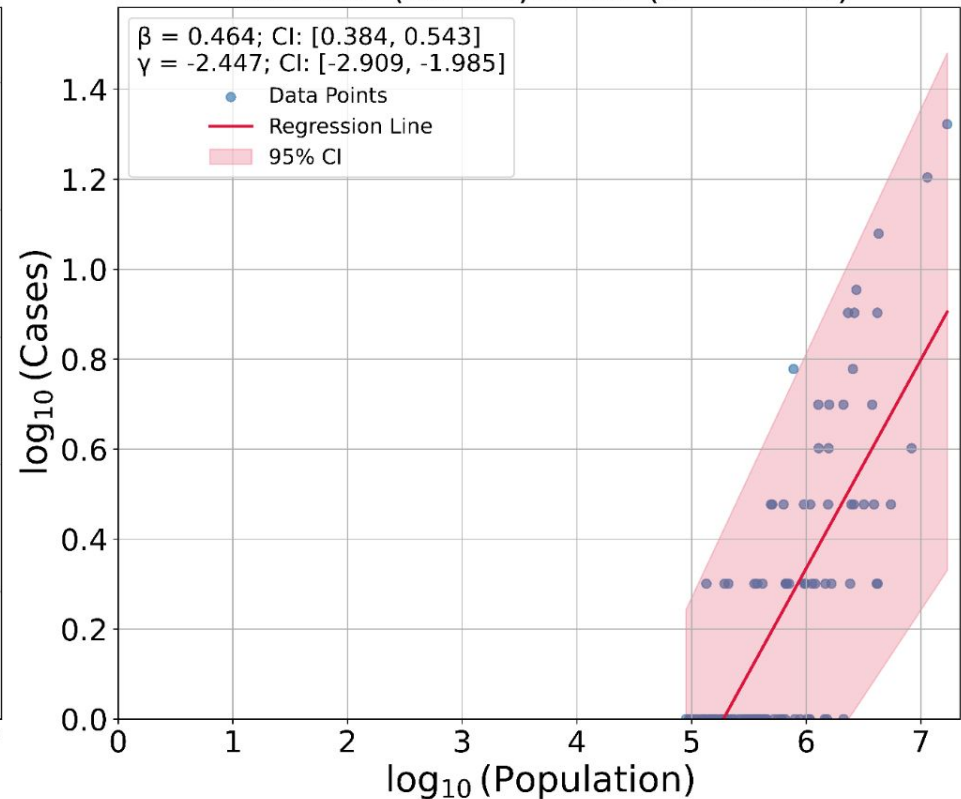




Worst Year (Annual): 1973 ($R^2 = 0.075$)

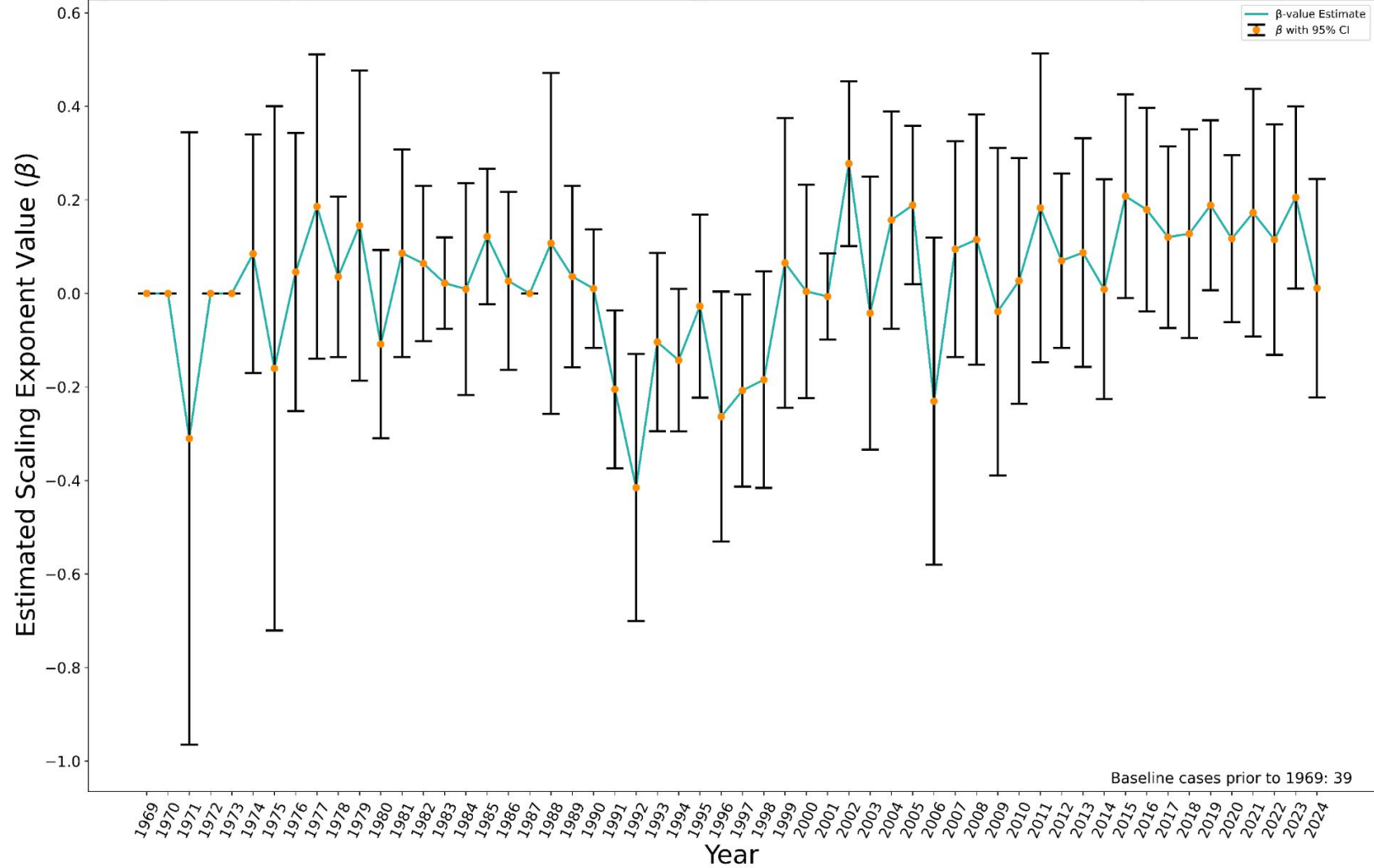


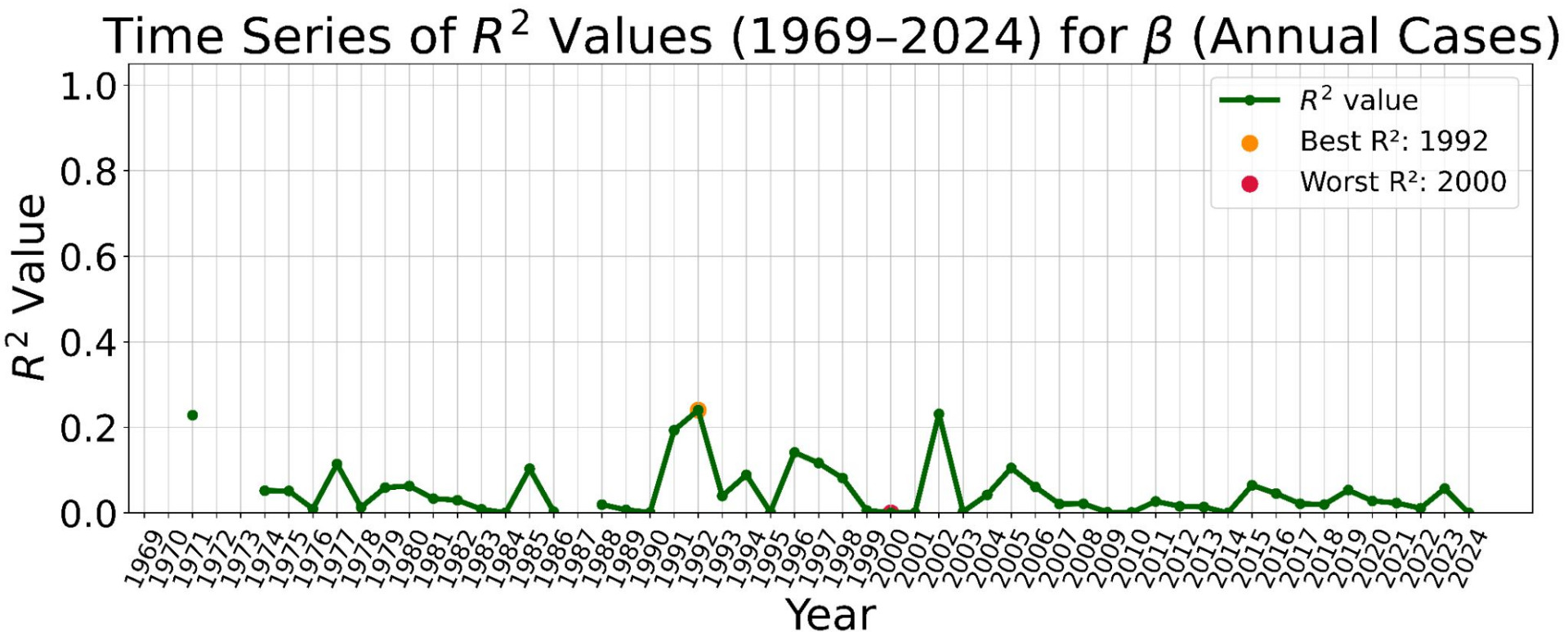
Best Year (Annual): 1991 ($R^2 = 0.562$)



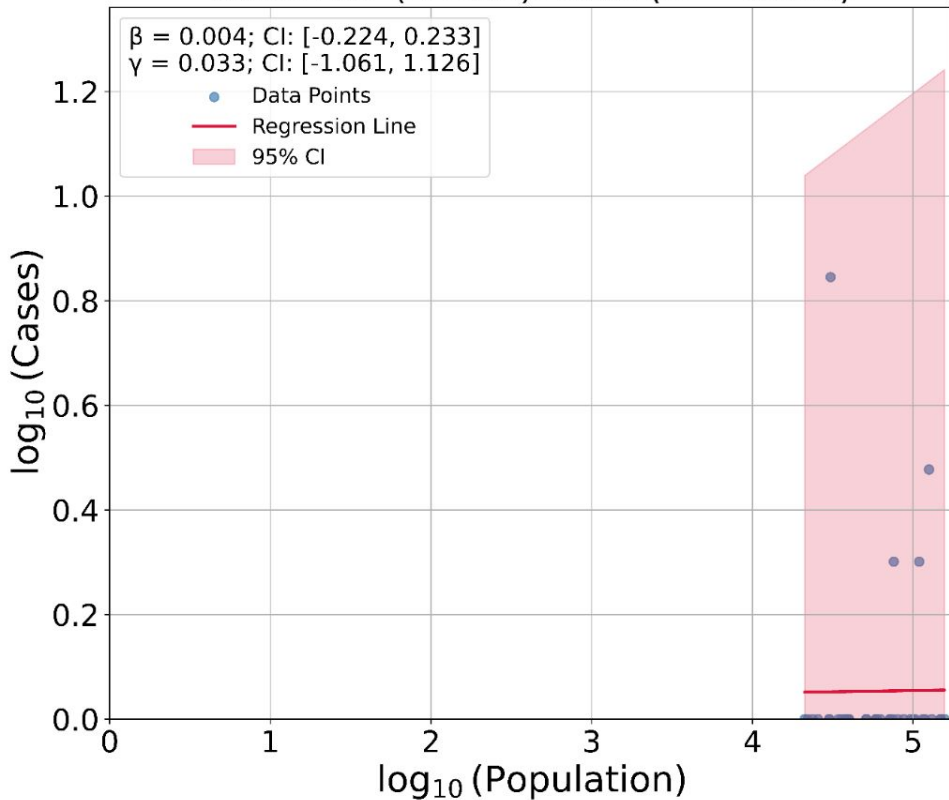
MicroSA-level

Scaling Exponent (β) of Annual NamUS Missing Person Cases vs MicroSA Population (1969-2024)

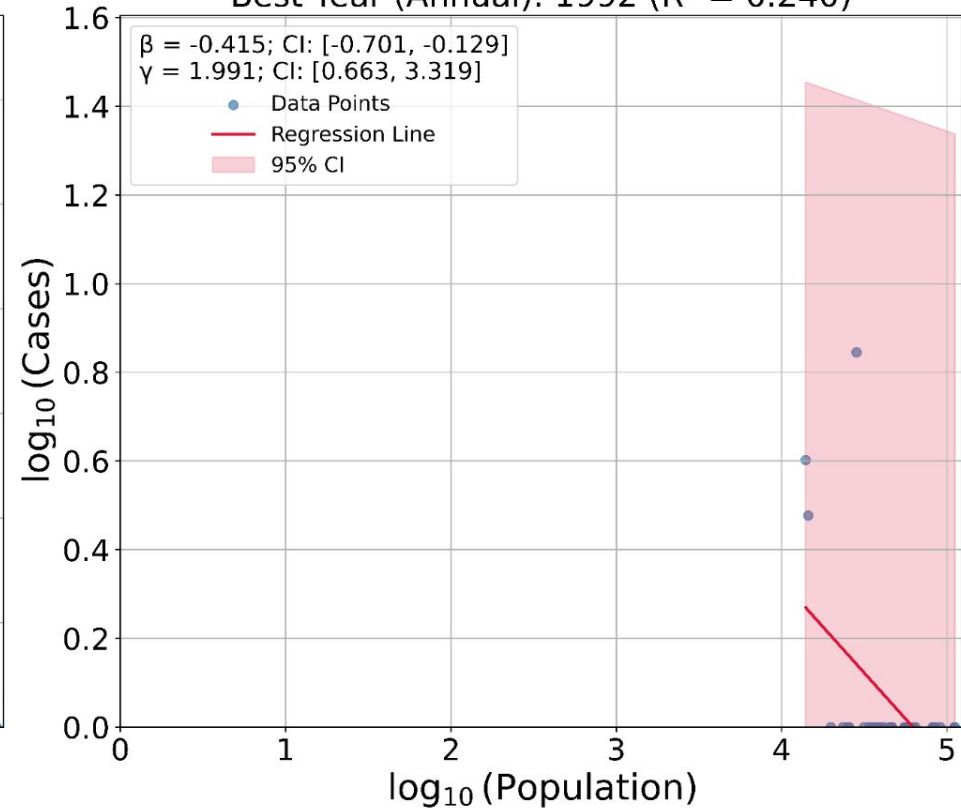




Worst Year (Annual): 2000 ($R^2 = 0.000$)



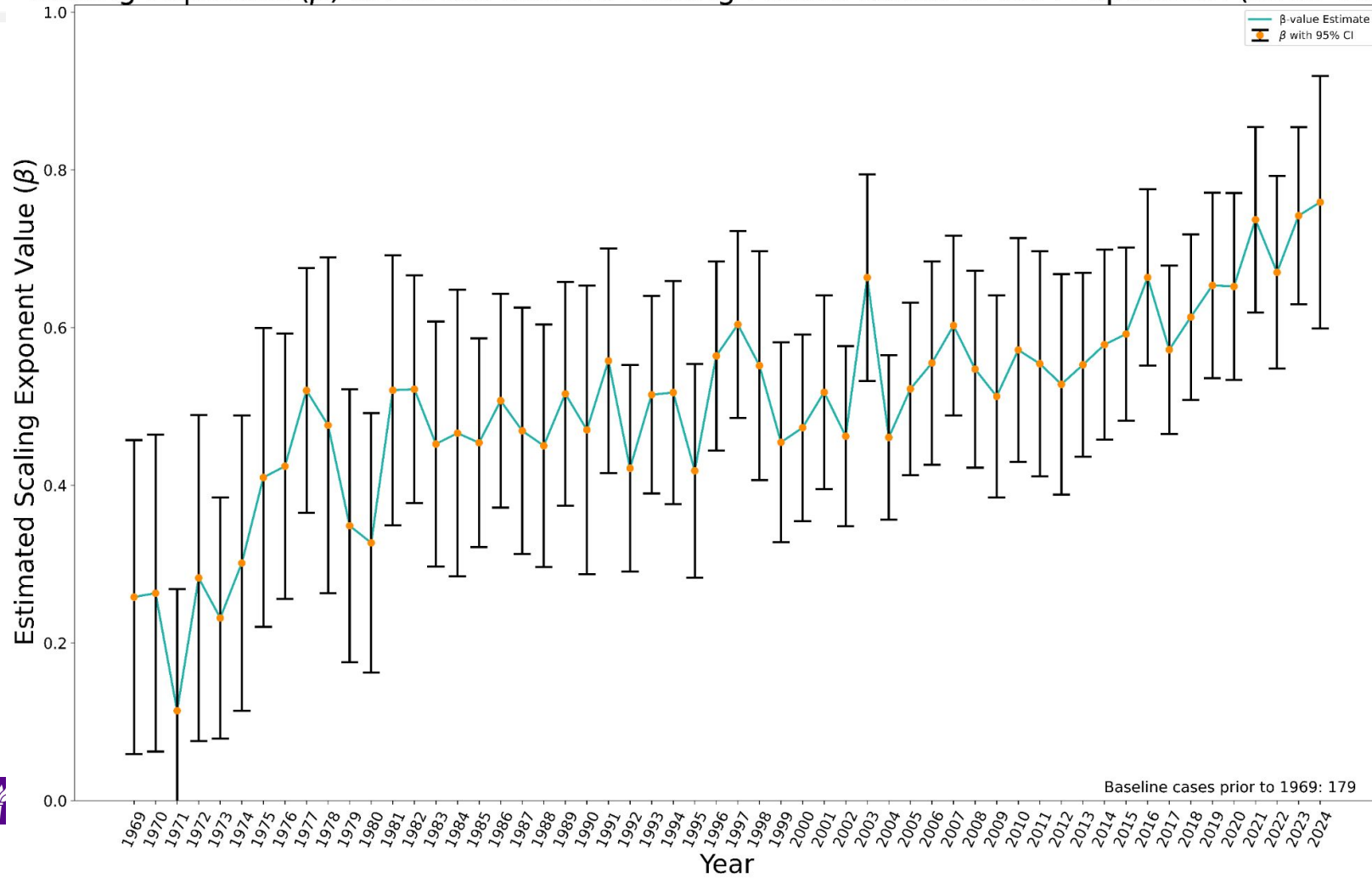
Best Year (Annual): 1992 ($R^2 = 0.240$)

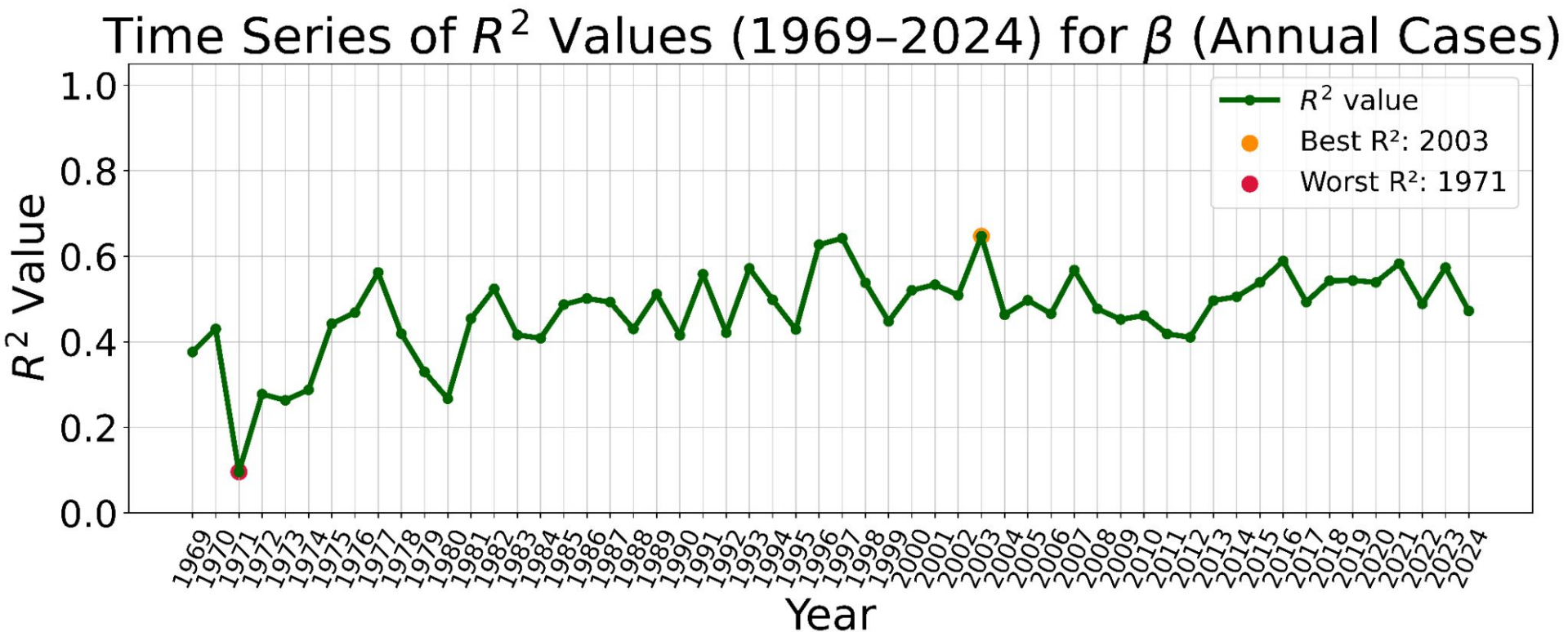


CSA-level

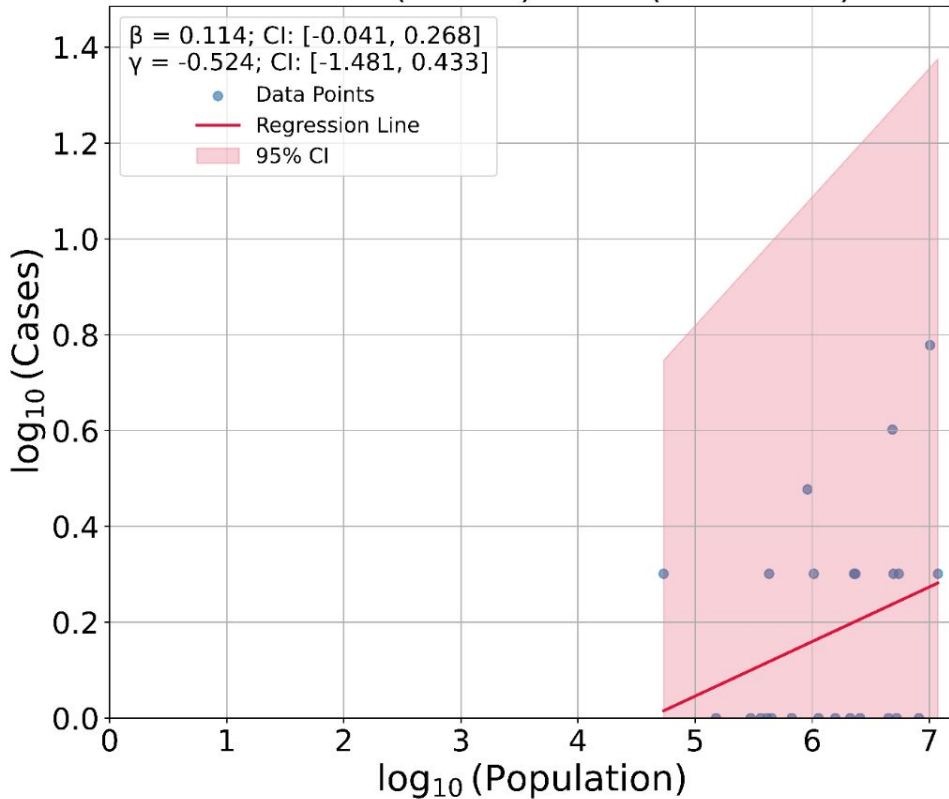


Scaling Exponent (β) of Annual NamUS Missing Person Cases vs CSA Population (1969–2024)

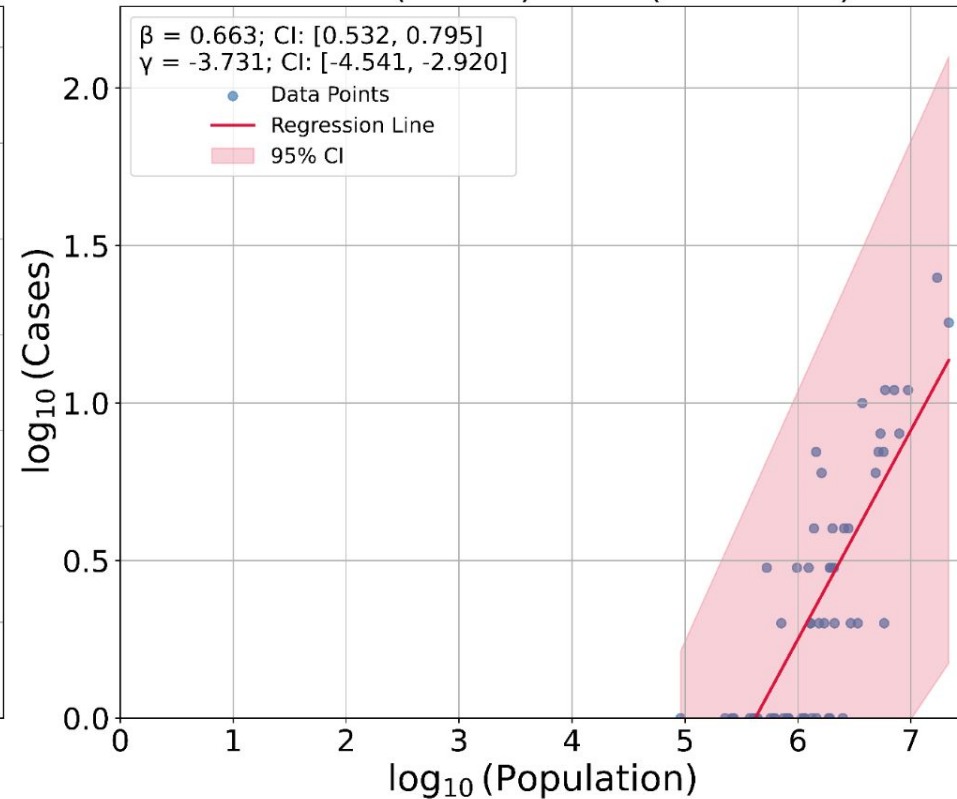




Worst Year (Annual): 1971 ($R^2 = 0.096$)



Best Year (Annual): 2003 ($R^2 = 0.647$)



Mexico INEGI Cases

Mexico Missing Persons Cases Data Characteristics

- We have **129,830** available records, with % **incomplete** by column:
 - Victim ID: **0.00%**
 - Origin Agency: **0.00%**
 - Date of Birth: **59.31%**
 - Sex: **37.05%**
 - Date of Incidence: **43.13%**
 - Date of Report: **41.52%**
 - Victim Status: **96.13%**
 - State: **2.26%**
 - State ID: **0.00%****
 - Municipality: **40.92%**
 - Municipality ID: **0.00%****
- Guide to Mexican Administrative Divisions
- The Mexico-American GEOID equivalencies by average population size **seem** to follow:
 - Mexican 'States' == American 'States'
 - Mexican 'Municipalities' == American 'Counties?' & American 'MSAs/CBSAs'
 - Extremely wide range of population values
 - Includes:
 - 'Ciudades'
 - 'Villas'
 - 'Pueblos'
 - ...
 - Mexican 'Localities' == American 'Blocks?'
 - Mexico City 'Boroughs' == American 'Counties'

incomplete entries are 'MISSING', 'UNKNOWN', or 'CENSORED'*

GEOID IDs that are incomplete have a specific code

Mexico by GEOIDS

States:



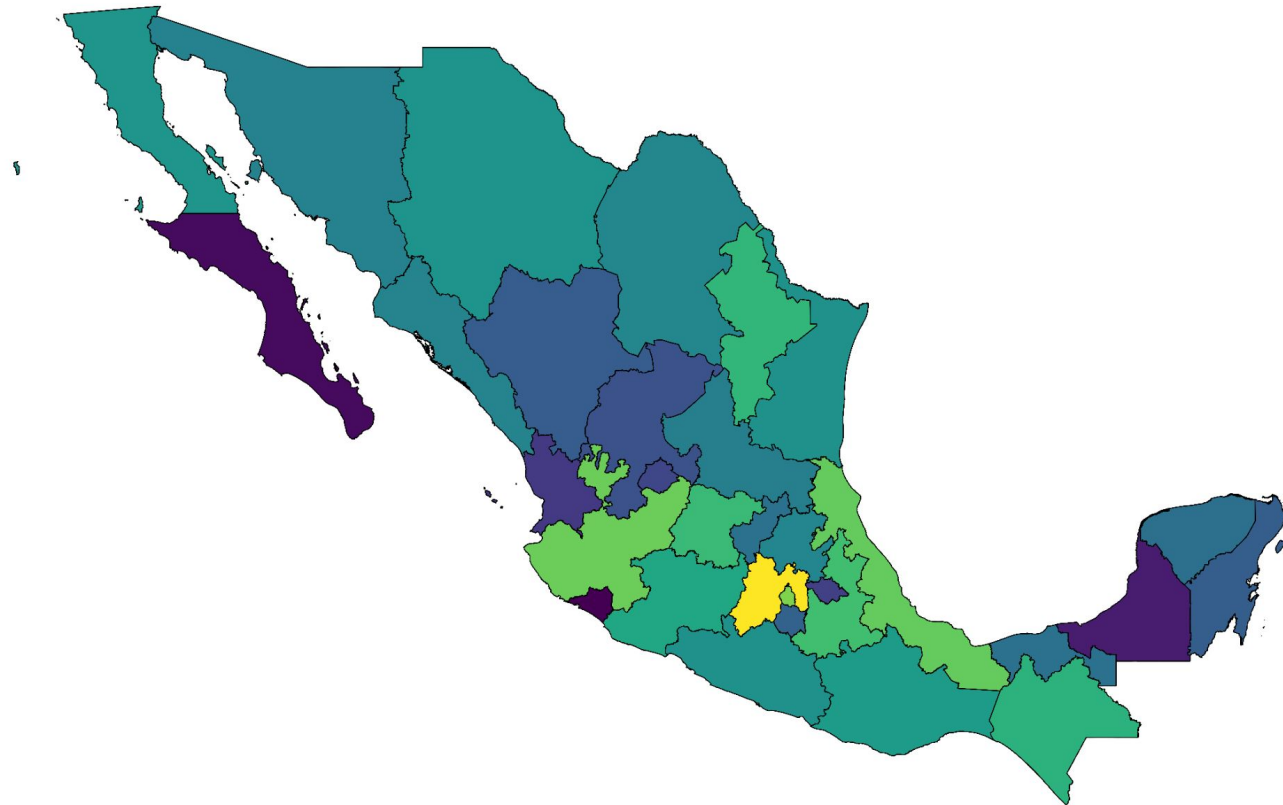
Municipalities:



By Eddo - This W3C-unspecified vector image was created with Adobe Illustrator., CC BY-SA 3.0,
<https://commons.wikimedia.org/w/index.php?curid=14581939>

By Goran tek-en, CC BY-SA 4.0,
<https://commons.wikimedia.org/w/index.php?curid=96160260>

2025 Mexican State Population Choropleth (Log Scaled)

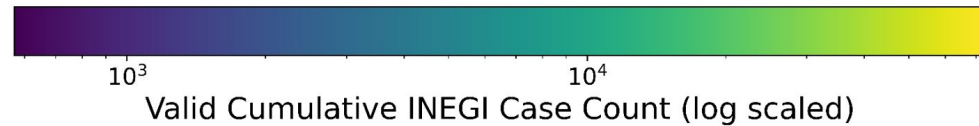
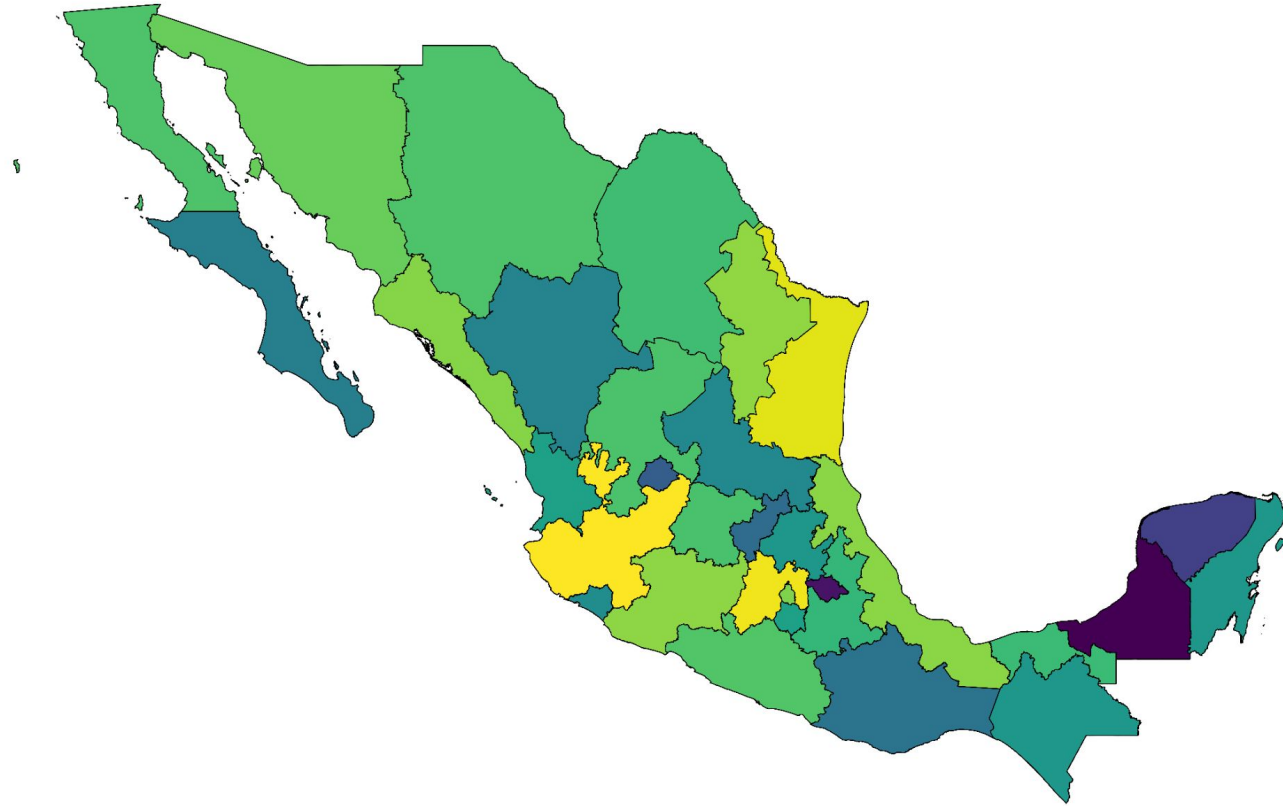


10^6

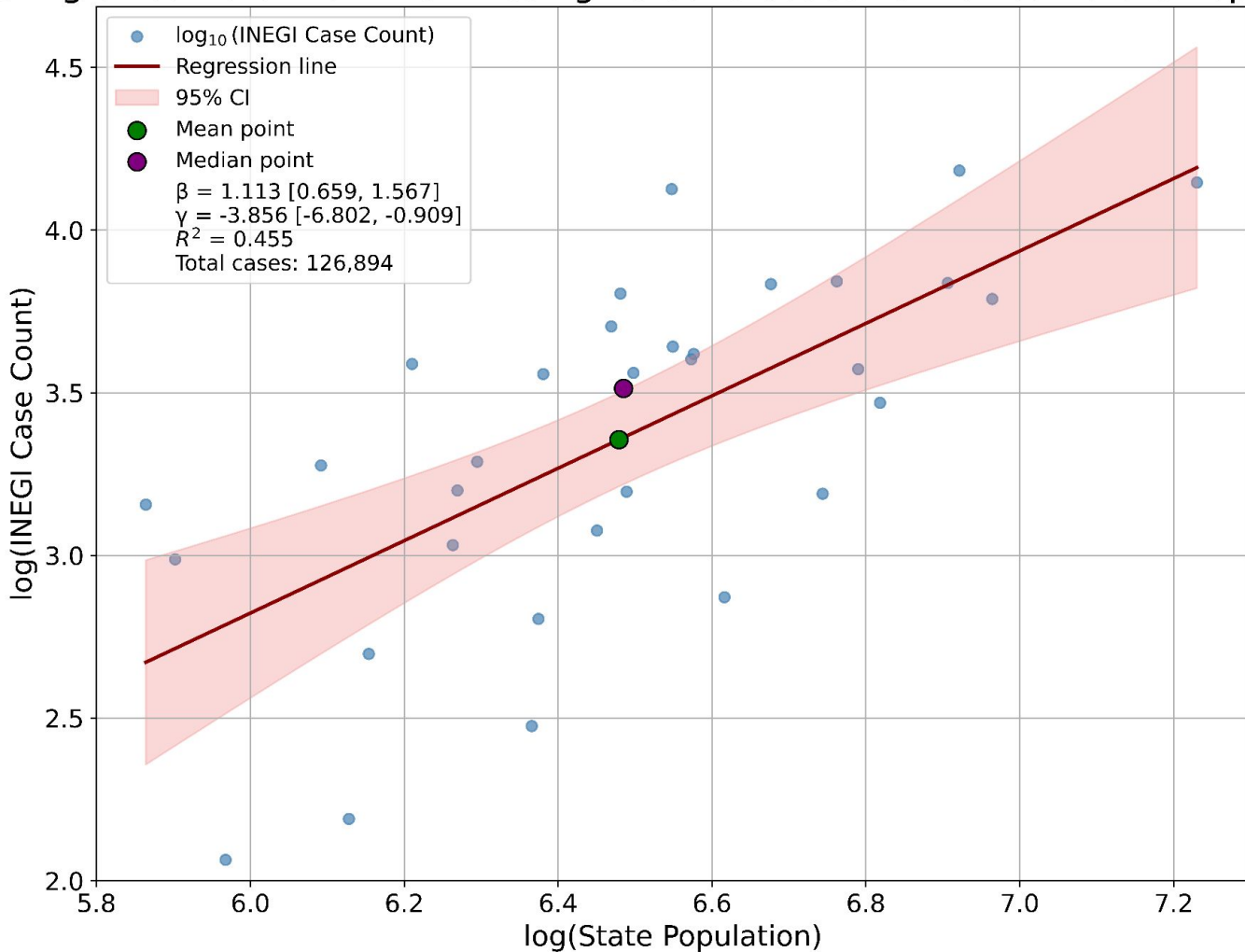
10^7

2025 Mexican State Population (Log Scaled)

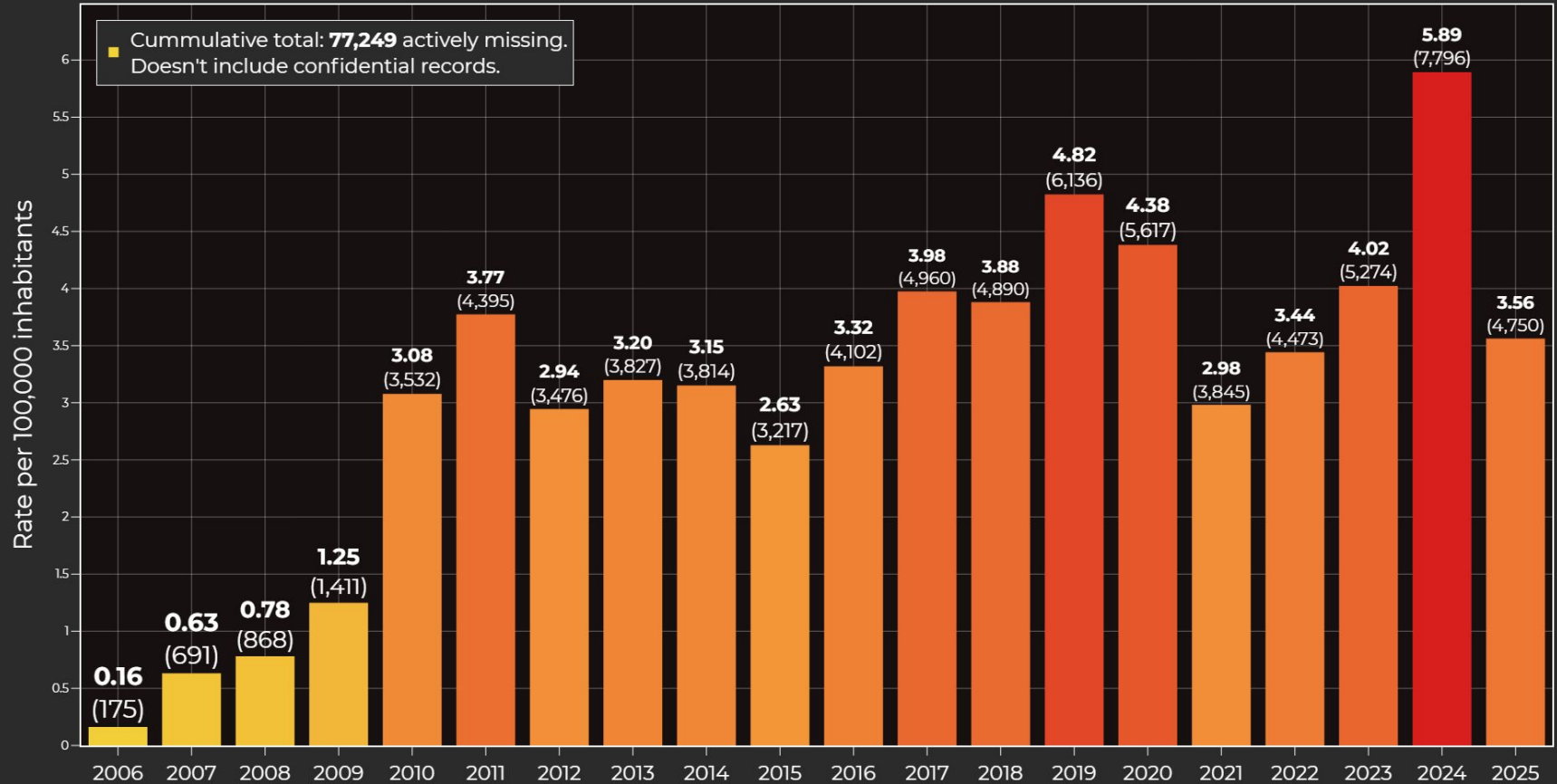
Valid INEGI Missing Persons Cases by Mexican State (Log Scaled)



Scaling of Cumulative INEGI Missing Persons Cases vs Mexican State Populations



Evolution of the rate of missing and unaccounted-for people in **Mexico** (2006-2025)

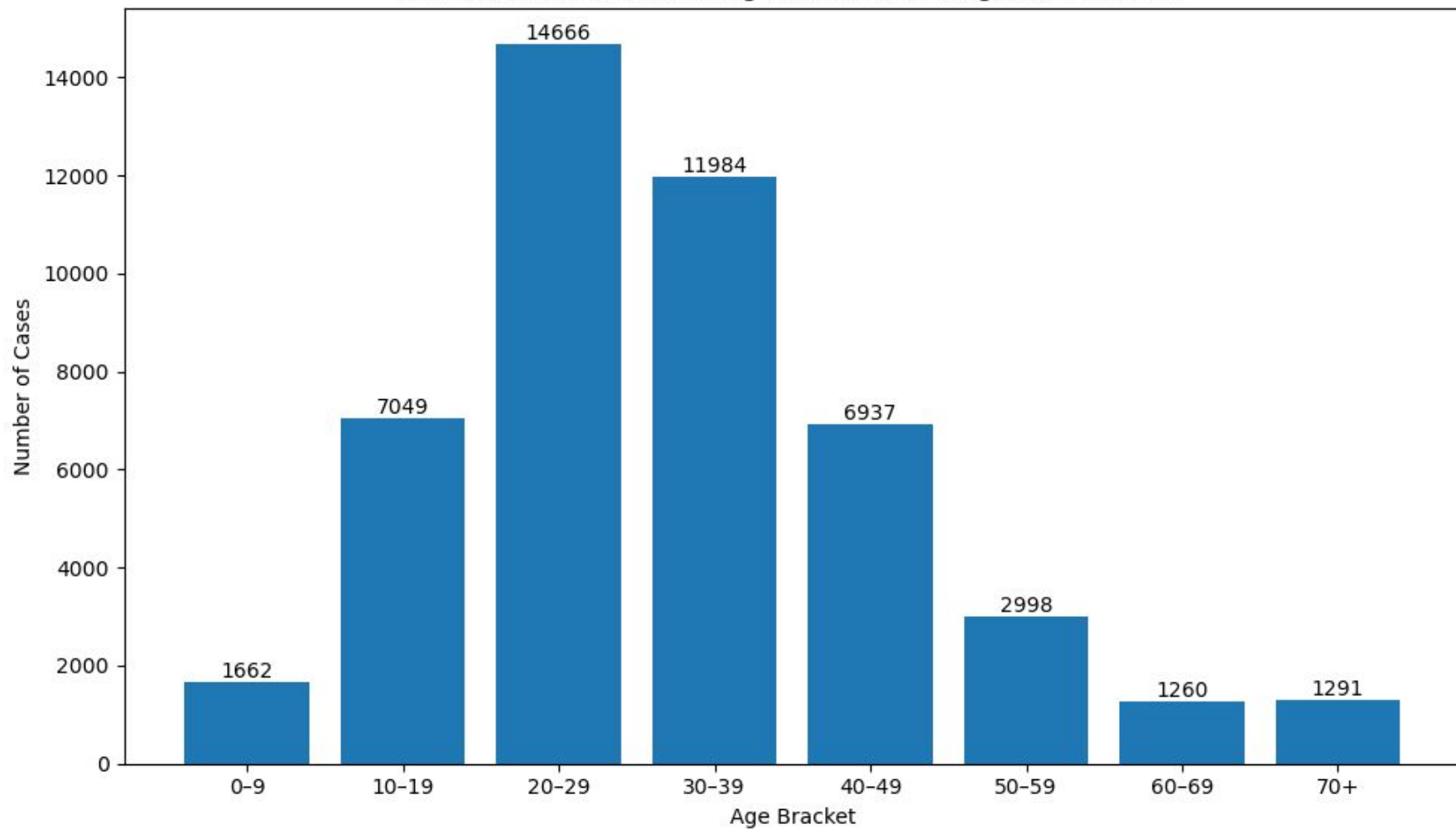


Source: RNPDO (July 2025)

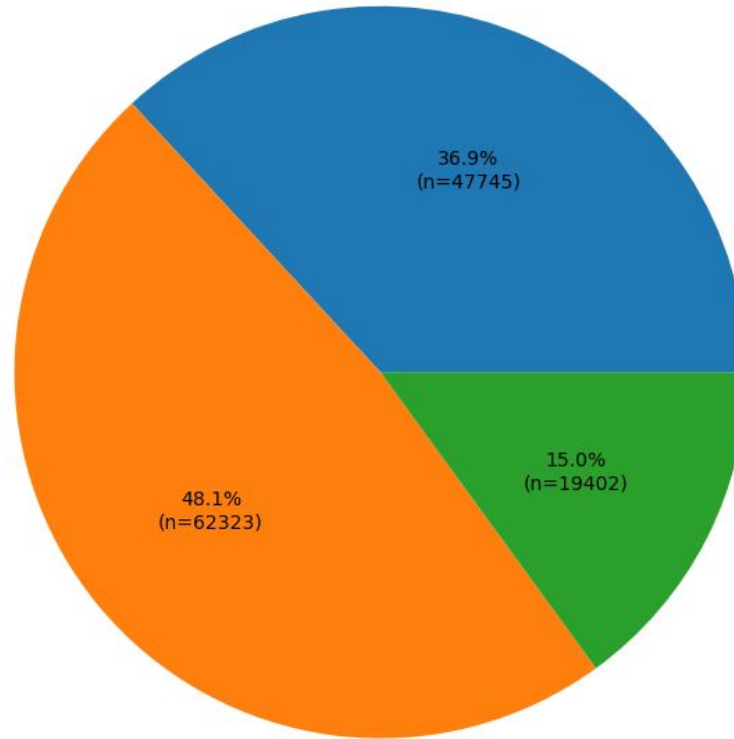
Year of incidence

@lapanquecita

Distribution of INEGI Missing Persons Cases: Ages at Incidence



Sex Distribution of INEGI Missing Persons Cases



Sex

